

A map of Queens, New York, with the five community districts shaded in dark gray. Community District 5, located in the central-eastern part of the borough, is highlighted in a bright yellow color. The map shows the surrounding water bodies, including the Long Island Sound and the Queens-Nassau Expressway (I-66) running along the western edge.

# ***Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests***

Fiscal Year  
2027

**Queens Community  
District  
5**

*Prepared by the Community Board  
December 2025*

NYC OpenData, New Jersey Office of GIS, Esri, TomTom, Garmin, SafeGraph,  
METI/NASA, USGS, EPA, NPS, USDA, USFWS

# INTRODUCTION

The annual Statements of Community District Needs (CD Needs Statements) and Community Board Budget Requests (Budget Requests) are Charter mandates that form an integral part of the City's budget process. Together, they are intended to support communities in their ongoing consultations with city agencies, elected officials and other key stakeholders and influence more informed decision making on a broad range of local planning and budget priorities. This report also provides a valuable public resource for neighborhood planning and research purposes, and may be used by a variety of audiences seeking information about New York City's diverse communities.

## HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

This report represents the Statement of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests for Fiscal Year (FY) 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board, collected through an online form available to community boards from June to November, 2025.

Community boards may provide substantive supplemental information together with their Statements and Budget Requests. This supporting material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting them into a web browser, such as Chrome, Safari or Firefox.

If you have questions about this report or suggestions for changes please contact:  
[CDNEEDS\\_DL@planning.nyc.gov](mailto:CDNEEDS_DL@planning.nyc.gov)

This report is broadly structured as follows:

### 1. **Overarching Community District Needs**

Sections 1 – 4 provide an overview of the community district and the top three pressing issues affecting this district overall as identified by the community board. Any narrative provided by the board supporting their selection of their top three pressing issues is included.

### 2. **Policy Area-Specific District Needs**

Section 5 is organized by seven distinct policy areas aligned with the service and program areas of city agencies. For each policy area, community boards selected the most important issue for their districts and could provide a supporting narrative. The policy area section also includes any agency-specific needs and a list of relevant budget requests submitted by the community board. If the community board submitted additional information outside of a specific policy area, it may be found in Section 6.

### 3. **Community Board Budget Requests**

The final section includes the two types of budget requests submitted to the City for the FY24 budget cycle; one list for capital and another for expense budget requests. For each budget request, community boards were able to provide a priority number, explanation, location, and supporters. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests submitted to city agencies.

## Disclaimer

This report represents the Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests of this Community District for Fiscal Year 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board.

*Budget Requests:* Listed for informational purposes only. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests and budget request responses.

*Budget Priorities:* Priority numbers apply to expense and capital Budget requests from all policy areas. A complete list of expense and capital budget requests by this Board sorted by priority can be found in Section 7 of this document.

*Supporting Materials:* Some community boards provided substantive supplemental information. This supportive material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting the links provided in the Appendix into a browser.

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# 1. COMMUNITY BOARD INFORMATION

Queens Community Board 5

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Address: 61-23 Myrtle Avenue  
Phone: 7183661834  
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Chair: Walter Sanchez  
District Manager: Gary Giordano

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## 2. 2020 CENSUS DATA

The following two pages contain data from the most recent 2020 Decennial Census, which includes basic demographic and housing characteristics for New York City, the borough, and this community district. The data also includes a view of change over time since 2010.

## New York City

|                                                  | 2010      |         | 2020      |         | Change, 2010-2020 |         |                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|-----------|---------|-------------------|---------|------------------|
|                                                  | Number    | Percent | Number    | Percent | Number            | Percent | Percentage Point |
| <b>AGE</b>                                       |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 8,175,133 | 100.00  | 8,804,190 | 100.00  | 629,057           | 7.7     | 0.0              |
| Total persons under 18 years                     | 1,768,111 | 21.6    | 1,740,142 | 19.8    | -27,969           | -1.6    | -1.8             |
| <b>MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN</b> |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 8,175,133 | 100.0   | 8,804,190 | 100.0   | 629,057           | 7.7     | 0.0              |
| Hispanic/Latino (of any race)                    | 2,336,076 | 28.6    | 2,490,350 | 28.3    | 154,274           | 6.6     | -0.3             |
| White non-Hispanic                               | 2,722,904 | 33.3    | 2,719,856 | 30.9    | -3,048            | -0.1    | -2.4             |
| Black non-Hispanic                               | 1,861,295 | 22.8    | 1,776,891 | 20.2    | -84,404           | -4.5    | -2.6             |
| Asian non-Hispanic                               | 1,028,119 | 12.6    | 1,373,502 | 15.6    | 345,383           | 33.6    | 3.0              |
| Some other race, non-Hispanic                    | 78,063    | 1.0     | 143,632   | 1.6     | 65,569            | 84.0    | 0.6              |
| Non-Hispanic of two or more races                | 148,676   | 1.8     | 299,959   | 3.4     | 151,283           | 101.8   | 1.6              |
| <b>HOUSING OCCUPANCY</b>                         |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total housing units                              | 3,371,062 | 100.0   | 3,618,635 | 100.0   | 247,573           | 7.3     | 0.0              |
| Occupied housing units                           | 3,109,784 | 92.2    | 3,370,448 | 93.1    | 260,664           | 8.4     | 0.9              |
| Vacant housing units                             | 261,278   | 7.8     | 248,187   | 6.9     | -13,091           | -5.0    | -0.9             |

## Queens

|                                                  | 2010      |         | 2020      |         | Change, 2010-2020 |         |                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------|---------|-----------|---------|-------------------|---------|------------------|
|                                                  | Number    | Percent | Number    | Percent | Number            | Percent | Percentage Point |
| <b>AGE</b>                                       |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 2,230,722 | 100.00  | 2,405,464 | 100.00  | 174,742           | 7.8     | 0.0              |
| Total persons under 18 years                     | 461,901   | 20.7    | 455,995   | 19      | -5,906            | -1.3    | -1.7             |
| <b>MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN</b> |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 2,230,722 | 100.0   | 2,405,464 | 100.0   | 174,742           | 7.8     | 0.0              |
| Hispanic/Latino (of any race)                    | 613,750   | 27.5    | 667,861   | 27.8    | 54,111            | 8.8     | 0.3              |
| White non-Hispanic                               | 616,727   | 27.6    | 549,358   | 22.8    | -67,369           | -10.9   | -4.8             |
| Black non-Hispanic                               | 395,881   | 17.7    | 381,375   | 15.9    | -14,506           | -3.7    | -1.8             |
| Asian non-Hispanic                               | 508,334   | 22.8    | 656,583   | 27.3    | 148,249           | 29.2    | 4.5              |
| Some other race, non-Hispanic                    | 39,923    | 1.8     | 66,175    | 2.8     | 26,252            | 65.8    | 1.0              |
| Non-Hispanic of two or more races                | 56,107    | 2.5     | 84,112    | 3.5     | 28,005            | 49.9    | 1.0              |
| <b>HOUSING OCCUPANCY</b>                         |           |         |           |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total housing units                              | 835,127   | 100.0   | 896,333   | 100.0   | 61,206            | 7.3     | 0.0              |
| Occupied housing units                           | 780,117   | 93.4    | 847,210   | 94.5    | 67,093            | 8.6     | 1.1              |
| Vacant housing units                             | 55,010    | 6.6     | 49,123    | 5.5     | -5,887            | -10.7   | -1.1             |

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files  
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

## Queens Community District 5

|                                                  | 2010    |         | 2020    |         | Change, 2010-2020 |         |                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------|---------|---------|---------|-------------------|---------|------------------|
|                                                  | Number  | Percent | Number  | Percent | Number            | Percent | Percentage Point |
| <b>AGE</b>                                       |         |         |         |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 169,190 | 100.00  | 178,178 | 100.00  | 8,988             | 5.3     | 0.0              |
| Total persons under 18 years                     | 36,481  | 21.6    | 33,591  | 18.9    | -2,890            | -7.9    | -2.7             |
| <b>MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN</b> |         |         |         |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total population                                 | 169,190 | 100.0   | 178,178 | 100.0   | 8,988             | 5.3     | 0.0              |
| Hispanic/Latino (of any race)                    | 58,650  | 34.7    | 64,221  | 36.0    | 5,571             | 9.5     | 1.3              |
| White non-Hispanic                               | 92,814  | 54.9    | 85,642  | 48.1    | -7,172            | -7.7    | -6.8             |
| Black non-Hispanic                               | 2,335   | 1.4     | 3,884   | 2.2     | 1,549             | 66.3    | 0.8              |
| Asian non-Hispanic                               | 13,026  | 7.7     | 19,241  | 10.8    | 6,215             | 47.7    | 3.1              |
| Some other race, non-Hispanic                    | 737     | 0.4     | 1,658   | 0.9     | 921               | 125.0   | 0.5              |
| Non-Hispanic of two or more races                | 1,628   | 1.0     | 3,532   | 2.0     | 1,904             | 117.0   | 1.0              |
| <b>HOUSING OCCUPANCY</b>                         |         |         |         |         |                   |         |                  |
| Total housing units                              | 65,818  | 100.0   | 69,416  | 100.0   | 3,598             | 5.5     | 0.0              |
| Occupied housing units                           | 61,762  | 93.8    | 65,075  | 93.7    | 3,313             | 5.4     | -0.1             |
| Vacant housing units                             | 4,056   | 6.2     | 4,341   | 6.3     | 285               | 7.0     | 0.1              |

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files  
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

### Statement on Data Accuracy

Under Title 13 of the U.S. Code, the Census Bureau is legally bound to protect the privacy of individuals participating in the decennial census. To adhere to the law and to avoid the disclosure of information about individual respondents, the Census Bureau has historically applied a host of techniques, such as top- and bottom-coding, imputation, table- and cell-suppression, and data swapping. The Census Bureau is employing a new technique with the 2020 Census, referred to as the Disclosure Avoidance System (DAS), based on differential privacy. With this approach, the Census Bureau “infuses noise” systematically across census data and sets a quantified disclosure risk, referred to as the Privacy Loss Budget (PLB).

While the new DAS approach may diminish the risk of disclosure concerns, it comes at a cost to data accuracy. Consequently, 2020 Census data users should be aware that all sub-state counts, except for housing units (which are unaffected by the DAS), may be adjusted to protect the privacy of Census participants and may be subject to reduced accuracy. Because DAS noise infusion is randomized, it is impossible for data users to know the degree to which any individual statistic is altered. However, it is possible to say that in general the relative size of errors decreases as counts increase. Consequently, data users should have greater confidence in the accuracy of the data as counts get larger. Further, an evaluation of a Privacy-Protected Microdata File (PPMF), treated with a Disclosure Avoidance System like the one applied to 2020 redistricting data, showed that counts of 300 or more rarely have sizable errors (error beyond +/- 10% of the count). Therefore, while data users need to be cognizant of data accuracy limitations, they should have confidence in conclusions based on sizable counts, which are relatively unaffected by the Census Bureau’s latest disclosure avoidance method.



### 3. OVERVIEW OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT

We are a community of people who have roots in many nations and places throughout the world. Regardless of where our forefathers and foremothers originally lived, the great majority came to our country for a better life. The overwhelming majority of New Yorkers and Americans have some simple requests: to live in peace, in a safe community, with good public resources and services. Families and individuals continue to risk their lives to make it to a place like America. Whether our ancestors immigrated to escape violence, hunger, economic instability or oppressive governments we should be honored to live in a country that continues to feed the dreams of immigrants everywhere. In Queens, there are known to be more than two and a half million residents with ancestry from well over 100 countries. This has and will increase demands on us nationally and in our communities. This, combined with the pressure on our environment, will demand that we work together cooperatively and intelligently. We have our faults as individuals and as a nation, but we have primarily strived to be a nation of the people, by the people, for the people, united under the belief in the Dream of a better life for ourselves, our loved ones and for future generations.

Since 2020, the Coronavirus (COVID-19) has caused the deaths of more than 1,207,000 Americans, and more than 47,000 NYC residents. In the Spring of 2020, hospitals in Our City were overwhelmed with patients. Dedicated doctors, nurses and EMS workers risked their lives to care for very sick patients. There were many days when more than 700 New Yorkers died of this terrible virus. In addition to tragic deaths, the economy of the USA and in Our City was severely damaged, resulting in tens of millions seeking unemployment insurance benefits and thousands of businesses not being able to operate. Thanks to New Yorkers wearing masks, social distancing themselves, washing their hands regularly, and taking vaccines, the number of residents contracting this deadly disease has decreased dramatically. Drug companies thankfully have developed vaccines, which since Spring 2021 have become widely available. More than \$3 trillion in relief has been distributed by the Federal government, causing national debt to skyrocket.

Our Community Board 5 area is comprised primarily of the Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale communities. We are also responsible for a few blocks of Woodside, Rego Park and Elmhurst. Our geographic boundaries are Maurice Avenue into Calamus Avenue to the north; the Brooklyn border with Bushwick on the south (Cypress Avenue, Wyckoff Avenue and Irving Avenue); Woodhaven Boulevard and the CSX Freight Rail Line in the east and the Brooklyn County line with our Williamsburg and Bushwick neighbors in the west. Like many communities in Queens, development of homes and non-farm businesses began at the turn of the 20th century and continued quite industriously through the 1950's. By the time of America's first moon landing, our neighborhoods were overwhelmingly constructed.

The 2020 Census indicates that there are approximately 184,714 residents living within District 5, Queens, but, like many communities in our City, we know the number of people really living here is significantly greater, considering under-counting and far too many illegal apartments. Locally, our population on paper has risen from 150,000 residents in 1990. We have had some new housing constructed in the past two decades, essentially where one-family homes with large lots have been replaced by two-family homes or multiple dwellings. The housing stock in our communities is mainly comprised of attached homes, ranging from one to six-family residences. Our most pressing problems include: the tragic deaths of more than 47,000 New Yorkers and the devastating economic effects of the Coronavirus (COVID-19), significant increases in crime until recently; illegal apartments, primarily in basements and cellars; too many drivers speeding, running traffic signals and stop signs; a significant reduction in the number of police officers assigned to the 104th Police Precinct since 1995; a growing number of sewer system breaks that cause dangerous conditions; illegal dumping and abuse of city litter baskets; a shortage of Parks maintenance workers to keep playgrounds and ball fields in good repair; and too many youth not doing well in school. The need for many services historically provided by City agencies is growing for numerous reasons. It is due

mainly to population increases and the age of specific communities' roadways, sewer lines, bridges and parks. These important assets must be well maintained or they will fall into serious disrepair, necessitating greater capital expenditures, sooner.

In an era when many City services had been cut back due to a declining tax base, volunteers have become the backbone of our community. Thank heavens for volunteers who serve diligently on Community Boards, not-for-profit organizations' boards of directors, civic organizations and block associations. Thanks to volunteers in the communities served by Community Board 5, Queens, children and teenagers are engaged in many sports and recreational activities, local parks are cleaner than they would be otherwise, and graffiti has been removed from many buildings. Many of the area needs that we have worked to accomplish for years seem much less consequential, after the September 11, 2001 disaster at the World Trade Center. Many families need psychological and financial assistance. Our world, in a devastating half-hour, is forever changed. The Police Department, who have done so much to reduce crime, will now be working increasingly with the FBI to greatly reduce the possibility of future terrorist disasters. After the Trade Center disaster, our wars in Iraq and Afghanistan have caused additional heartache throughout the country. Considering the severe economic recession that hit our country in 2008, the devastating economic impact of the Coronavirus Pandemic, and threats of government budget cuts in too many important funding categories, every effort must be made to ensure that government expenditures are prudent, that waste is reduced and that Medicaid, Medicare and other fraud are eliminated.

In the past 3 years, more than 200,000 asylum seekers and migrants have come to New York City, often without a place to live and bringing only what they can carry. This migration has overwhelmed our City Shelter System, is putting significant pressure on public schools and for other city resources. Our city has had little help from the federal government to pay for sheltering, feeding and educating these newcomers. In addition, the federal government needs to make provisions so that the new adult asylum seekers and migrants are given a fair hearing, are permitted to work, and that immigrants that are in the United States of America longer are given reasonable opportunities for eventual citizenship.

## 4. TOP THREE PRESSING ISSUES OVERALL

### Queens Community Board 5

The three most pressing issues facing this Community Board are:

#### **Emergency and disaster response**

It is very difficult to state that there are 3 definite most important issues facing the communities that many of us have worked for decades to stabilize and improve. There is probably nothing more important to safeguard and improve than the air we share and the water we drink, since life is not possible without these essential resources. Sanitation services, removal and treatment of sewage, stormwater removal, health services and basic medicines are critical in preventing unhealthy conditions and disease. Police are essential, as are Firefighters and EMS workers, to safeguard the people and for response to emergencies. People need to earn a living in order to pay for housing, to buy food and pay for essential services provided by the municipal government. A quality business environment is important so that the people are gainfully employed and earning enough income to at least meet their essential needs. Since the great majority of us do not have the luxury of walking to our place of employment, reliable, safe public transportation and stable, smooth roads, bridges and tunnels are vital for us to get where we need to go. Children, teens, young adults and all of us need to be increasingly educated and skilled to propel a civilized society in an ever more competitive, more global environment. Few of us are willing to live in tents, therefore quality, affordable housing is essential. Since living in a city presents fairly crowded conditions, where the great majority of us don't have our own private outdoor space, safe public parks provide important "outdoor" recreational space and, like cultural spaces, a place for people of all ages to communicate, socialize and rejuvenate. All of the societal categories listed above are very important, so the questions are where is our city most in need at the current time, to our far from complete knowledge.

Emergency response is almost always the most important issue facing our Community Board area. Having at least 170 Police Officers, plus supervisors, assigned to the 104th Police Precinct is one of our expense budget priorities each year. The number of Police Officers assigned to the 104th Police Precinct has declined significantly in recent years. This reduction forces officers and supervisors to hold more 911 calls, too often has put our precinct in backlog and alert status, and forces police to too often take one 911 call after another. Since the start of the COVID-19 Pandemic in 2020, crime has increased in our city and in the communities we have worked to stabilize and improve. The 104th Police Precinct now has fewer than 130 Police Officers working to safeguard residents, workers and visitors in the communities of Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale. We need at least 170 Police Officers, exclusive of supervisors, to better reduce crime, to enforce traffic safety laws and curtail speeding drivers, and to patrol the communities in District 5, Queens more effectively. Even considering City budget difficulties resulting from health and economic costs caused by the Coronavirus Pandemic, beginning in March 2020, every effort must be made to at least keep the number of brave Firefighters and Officers, EMS Crews and Hospital Staffing at pre-COVID levels. This tragic pandemic showed the need for these emergency response personnel in our large, ethnically diverse city.

#### **Street flooding**

Street flooding is an ongoing pressing issue in Community District 5, Queens. Solutions still need to be found to reduce flooding during heavy rains in the Glendale community. This includes the area of 77 Avenue and 78 Avenue, from 76 Street to 88 Street, and along Cooper Avenue from 74 Street to 78 Street. Sewer capital projects will need to be funded to solve these flooding problems. We are informed that Project No. SE877 has finally been established to provide larger sewers in the Glendale community, especially for 77 Avenue, between 76 Street and 88 Street, which is the low

point where storm water cascades downhill from Myrtle Avenue during rainstorms. The heavy rains of September 1, 2021 caused many homes along 77 Avenue to be flooded by more than 2 feet of storm water in basements. Therefore, city sewer upgrades in this low lying area of Glendale are more necessary than ever, especially considering the likelihood that global warming conditions will produce more heavy rainstorms in the future. We have succeeded in obtaining funding from the N.Y. City Dept. of Environmental Protection budget for capital projects, to increase sewers capacity in the Penelope Avenue/74 Street area of Middle Village and in the Calamus Avenue/69 Street area on the Maspeth/Woodside border. It is imperative that the 77 Avenue Area of Glendale have sewers that can cope with heavy rains.

## **Traffic**

Traffic and pedestrian safety have become much more of a concern in recent years. Too many drivers speed throughout our communities and our city, too many do not obey traffic signals and stop signs , and too many impatient, disrespectful drivers do not give pedestrians the right of way. We receive regular requests from community residents for traffic calming measures at corners and on residential blocks. We have consistently requested traffic signals and "all way stop" designations to improve pedestrian and driver safety. Since the great majority of intersections in our communities already have what the N.Y. City Department of Transportation considers to be adequate traffic controls, there are more and more residential requests for speed bumps or even traffic direction changes to deter drivers from speeding in communities. Traffic conditions are compounded in recent years with many more people travelling city streets on motorbikes, scooters and battery propelled bicycles. Too many people using these lighter transportation choices do not stop at traffic signals, or stop signs, putting others, especially pedestrians, and themselves, at risk of serious injury. Too many of these drivers of smaller vehicles even drive on city sidewalks putting pedestrians at even further risk. We need enforcement, and we also need drivers to be more educated, respectful to pedestrians and other drivers. Traffic conditions are even more stressed with tractor trailers, smaller trucks and delivery vehicles too often speeding, not obeying traffic laws and being driven on non-truck routes throughout our city.

Adopting laws that mandate that drivers with a history of speeding and reckless driving must have speed regulators installed in their vehicles are likely overdue, and drivers should not be permitted to have more than 5 significant speeding and/or reckless driving violations within a year before stern government action is taken.

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## 5. SUMMARY OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT NEEDS AND BUDGET REQUESTS

### HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

#### Queens Community Board 5

##### Most Important Issue Related to Healthcare and Human Services

###### **Services for domestic violence victims**

The Coronavirus (COVID-19), which started ravaging NYC in early 2020, is the equivalent of a plague which has caused more than 47,000 deaths in Our City and more than 1,207,000 deaths in the USA. In Our City, incidents of this dastardly virus have been reduced dramatically. Fortunately vaccines became available beginning in early 2021. Unfortunately too many people in our Nation refused to get vaccinated. We have many freedoms, but when so many people live and work in close proximity to others refusing to be vaccinated, when the COVID vaccines have proven to be very safe, is not responsible. Much of what needs to be done to stem this virus is for people to be vaccinated. This terrible, deadly virus would have caused many more deaths if responsible people didn't wear masks, social distance and cleanse their hands often.

In the short term, this deadly virus may have been the most important issue facing all of us worldwide. Yet, domestic violence problems and the need for better mental health treatment are critical issues that will need to be solved ongoing, whether there is a COVID-19 pandemic or some other major health crisis. All of the above listed issues are important, but Domestic Violence is the issue that is likely the most pressing, as this problem results in many 911 responses by Police, causes too much tragedy harming too many people.

Mental Health Issues and substance abuse are also very important to address, as these problems are the cause of much domestic violence and criminal activity. The USA has been too violent for far too long, especially when one considers that violent crime rates in the great majority of other "industrialized countries" are much lower. Too often violence, meanness and the degradation of women is almost glorified in music, movies, video games and other entertainment. There are too many negative vs. positive influences afflicting society. Respect for others, especially men for women, is essential to reduce abuse & domestic violence.

A significant concern is that, according to the last N.Y. City Community Health Survey in 2012, approximately 239,000 adults living in N.Y. City have problems with Serious Mental Illness, but only about 60% of these people in need have received mental health treatment in the past year. There seems to be a large gap between the number of people needing mental health treatment and the availability of this important treatment. There are reportedly also critical affordability issues for many people in need of mental health treatment, either because they are not adequately insured or because they haven't the necessary insurance or funds to pay for treatment that is often critically needed.

##### Community District Needs Related to Healthcare and Human Services

###### **Needs for Health Care and Facilities**

Ridgewood Medical Center, now renamed Gotham Health/Cumberland, located at 769 Onderdonk Avenue in Ridgewood, is a NYC Health and Hospitals Corporation facility that now serves residents of all ages. This Center is needed for poor and low-income residents of Ridgewood and neighboring communities. Once known as the Maspeth Child Health Station, and then Ridgewood Communicare Health Center, thousands of children, ages newborn to six, received health services here for decades. The fact that residents of all ages can now receive health care at this



neighborhood site is very important, especially for school-age children who might not see a doctor otherwise. Additional hours of operation should be added, especially on evenings and Saturdays, to meet increased demand and parent working hours.

Elmhurst Hospital, an HHC facility located outside of the CB5Q area, has a very good reputation as a City Hospital. This standing is even more impressive when one considers the diverse ethnic make-up of the people served at this hospital. Quality care and renovations at Elmhurst Hospital are very important to all of Queens. While Wyckoff Heights Medical Center and St. John's Hospital had been the primary health sites for CB5Q area residents, we are in Elmhurst Hospital's catchment area and are dependent upon this hospital's emergency room in critical times. The closures in 2009 of both St. John's Queens Hospital and Mary Immaculate Hospital could severely hurt health care in Queens. Every effort should be made to replace these hospitals with medical facilities, if doing so as hospitals is cost-prohibitive.

Bureau of Pest Control inspection and extermination services are an important priority. With as many or more rats in the City as people, it is very short-sighted and potentially dangerous to fund this arm of the Health Department at inadequate levels.

### **Needs for Older NYs**

The neighborhoods of Community District 5, Queens have a very large senior citizen population and many of these seniors are living into their late seventies and eighties. As a result, there is more of a need than ever for "Meals on Wheels", transportation, and other services for the frail elderly. Congregate meals programs continue to be important, so that seniors get to socialize, exercise, and receive good hot meals. Caregiver Programs that give comfort and free time to family members who care for frail seniors are also very important, especially considering how these family members have saved government so much cost of nursing homes and other types of formal care. Alzheimer's Programs and other mental health services are a critical need, as many seniors are living well into their eighties. Housing for seniors is another important need. Well-supervised nursing homes, where background checks are done to prevent abuse of senior citizen residents, is essential. The Coronavirus Pandemic (COVID-19) caused senior centers to close in March 2020. Thousands of seniors have tragically died from this devastating virus in NY City alone. Senior meals were being delivered to the great majority of those who had eaten and enjoyed activities at the senior center. A significant concern is that, because of this deadly virus and seniors being most at-risk, seniors have become more isolated. This isolation from loved ones is mentally and emotionally harmful to seniors. Many seniors need transportation to medical appointments. This is especially true for frail, low-income seniors, who should likely be given priority for any Access-A-Ride type programs and any pilot programs for seniors unable to take public transportation.

Senior housing is an important need in our community and in society. Many seniors have low or modest incomes, primarily through Social Security. Senior Housing is needed that is not out of character with other buildings in the community, considering that too many seniors have great difficulty paying apartment rents that are increasingly expensive. Too many seniors are rent burdened, having to spend much more than 30% of their income for housing. With so many people living into their 70s and 80s, there are estimates that the senior citizen population in many cities will increase by 40% in upcoming years. We need more housing for seniors and that housing needs to be affordable.

### **Needs for Homeless**

The homeless population in New York City, and the lack of affordable housing for many New Yorkers, is a serious concern. Yet, any plans to build large facilities to warehouse the homeless or to pack homeless people into hotels is unwise. There are still a large number of vacant buildings and lots, where residents without homes can have a place to live. This requires renovation and new construction. Why not hire professionals to teach people who are without a stable place to live to renovate and/or build housing for themselves? This would provide more housing at lower cost while teaching people a skill at the same time. Providing rent subsidies through thoughtful, carefully run

programs to those who are at risk of becoming homeless, or those individuals already struggling to live in the homeless shelter system, is likely one of the best solutions to housing the homeless and those at risk of homelessness. Rent subsidies need to be combined with quality counseling, education, employment, substance abuse prevention/intervention services, domestic violence services, and mental health services if those at risk are to really be helped now and for the longer term. The provision of professional legal services for people being harassed by landlords and/or in danger of eviction from their apartment is an important need in an effort to prevent homelessness. Some of the good news, according to the N.Y. Dept. of Homeless Services, is that evictions were down 27%, and family homelessness had been reduced in New York City, for the first time in a decade prior to the surge in asylum seekers and migrants.

There has been a surge, since 2022, of migrants entering the U.S.A. at our southern border. As of mid-October, 2024, more than 200,000 migrants have come to New York City seeking work and a place to live. These people are primarily fleeing countries like Venezuela and Central American countries where they are escaping violence and governments that are either oppressive, corrupt and/or incompetent. The influx of these people has greatly increased the number of people that need services through the N.Y. City Dept. of Homeless Services and the Human Resources Administration. Assistance is needed from the federal government to provide for these people in the short term, so that they can become independent and earn a living to support themselves and their families. The federal government has not provided much funding to New York City and other localities to help with the expense of housing, educating and providing food for these migrants. The federal government needs to provide our City and others with more financial assistance and these migrants need to be granted work authorization.

### **Needs for Low Income NYs**

Responsible provisions for those in need is important in a civilized, overly competitive society. While the number of people in NYC receiving public assistance has been reduced in recent years, the societal safety net is important. Too many people are unemployed, under employed and lack education levels and skills necessary to obtain a job in which they earn enough to pay for food, housing, medical insurance, doctor visits, clothing, utilities, and other basic needs. The loss of manufacturing jobs in the USA has meant that opportunities are lacking, in too many situations. Jobs have been transferred by USA companies to other countries, where work environments are unhealthy, unsafe, and where workers, some as young as teens, were earning \$1 an hour, working 16 hours a day (e.g. Apple Products made at Foxconn plants), and sleeping in barracks like conditions. It would be better for the people of the USA, and cities like New York, if companies and their stockholders were much less greedy. Manufacturing jobs should be brought back to the USA, so that our citizens can be gainfully employed and people paid a living wage for their efforts.

In the great majority of cases, crime, despair, substance abuse, and mental health problems are highest in those communities where unemployment and underemployment is all too much the norm. The bottom line is that, for too long, increased corporate profits may have meant more income for some but has reduced opportunities for many of our people. This is becoming more and more of a national security issue, especially regarding technology.

Food stamps, housing subsidies, and Medicaid are essential for far too many, and need to be provided for those truly in need. This need would be greatly diminished if manufacturing employment was brought back to the USA. Another problem is that in too many cases skilled jobs may be available (e.g. construction, plumbing, electrical), but there are not enough people with the necessary skills to fill these employment opportunities. Employment training, with a priority in marketable fields, is very important. A 4 year college diploma is certainly not the only path to a good living and teaching people trade skills should be a priority. For instance, news reports state that more than 50,000 new truck drivers will be needed each year in the USA, for at least a decade, to transport food and goods in a timely manner.

Sadly, many of the most vulnerable residents are senior citizens, who are faced with soaring housing expenses, and too often have to chose between paying for essential medicines instead of healthy food and other necessities. Safeguarding at-risk elderly citizens is vital in a civilized society.

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## HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                                 |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DFTA   | 1 / 1    | Provide needed services for Seniors                                                   |
| DOHMH  | 1 / 1    | Hire additional personnel for pest control                                            |
| HHC    | 1 / 1    | Other expense budget request for HHC (Ridgewood Medical Center)                       |
| HRA    | 1 / 1    | Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing |

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

#### **Educational attainment**

Far too many children and teens are performing below grade level in too many schools. What kind of a future will they have if they are not reasonably well educated, and at least secure a high school diploma? Not everyone is academically inclined, and many are much more interested in learning a skill (e.g. electrical, plumbing, carpentry, automotive repair, and food services), but without at least a high school diploma obtaining any employment paying a living wage is very difficult. Young people need to prize learning more, but many of their influences are negative like music, movies, social media and television that promote entertainment and disrespect instead of learning.

After school tutoring programs have been one of the best services that help children and teens to learn in a smaller setting & boost their confidence. The Coronavirus Pandemic (COVID-19) caused schools throughout NYC, and much of the USA to close during March, 2020. Students had to learn remotely from home. This caused parents in many cases to substitute for teachers, and many children and teens did not have access to the internet or a computer at home and in homeless shelter residences. Our City had to quickly provide both iPad computers and/or internet access for several hundred thousand students. There is little doubt that the education of too many children and teenagers has been set back as a result of their not being able to attend school until September of 2020. There is concern, especially for Special Needs Students and students needing occupational and other therapies. Fortunately, thus far, as of late October 2024, there has been a relatively low rate of students or education staff contracting the virus. Our society will have much ground to make up to get millions of students performing well.

### Community District Needs Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

#### **Needs for Youth Education**

Overcrowding in our local schools has been a great concern throughout Community School District 24, of which the communities of CB5 Queens are a major part. Historically, Community School District 24 has been among the most overcrowded in the City. While this is not true in all neighborhoods, it has certainly been a problem in the Ridgewood community.

In the past 12 years, we have seen the completion of two new public schools in Ridgewood, one on Metropolitan Avenue at Tonsor Street, P.S. 290; and another one on Seneca Avenue at DeKalb Avenue, P.S. 320. In the past 17 years we have also seen the completion of two new schools: at PS 128 and another at PS 305, as well as school additions at I.S. 77, P.S. 49, P.S. 87, and P.S. 113. A new high school opened on Metropolitan Avenue, east of Woodhaven Boulevard, in September, 2010. Because of the need for additional space for high school students, construction of a new high school on 74 Street at 57 Avenue, in Maspeth, for 1,100 students, was completed in September 2012.

Considering the need for high school education space locally, CB5Q requests that new high schools be constructed in Queens, including a new trade school.. The Department of Education plans to construct new schools, mini-schools and school additions are much needed, considering current and projected classroom overcrowding, especially with the requirement for smaller class sizes. The education of children, pre-teens, and teenagers has suffered when attempts are made to teach in gyms and auditoriums. Plans for new schools should consider adjacent residential and business communities. In general, the Mayor, elected officials, and the NYC Department of Education should strategically prioritize the provision of adequate learning space and the ongoing, regular repair and maintenance of educational facilities.

Child care is an important need in our society, considering that parents need to work to earn enough income to pay ever increasing expenses. Creating more child care centers is certainly a significant need in many communities, as are Pre School Programs, such as

Pre-K. Early education is known to be very beneficial for children, and helps them develop important social and emotional skills. Census statistics indicate that there are more than 8,800 children, under age 5, that are living in Community District 5, Queens.

### **Needs for Youth and Child Welfare**

There are few issues in life that are more upsetting and more alarming than children being abused, especially by their parents or a family member. The fact that there are 55,000 cases of child abuse or neglect annually in N.Y. City indicates the enormous pressure on the Administration for Children's Services to intervene, to safeguard the well-being and life of children and teenagers. The immediate priority is that there are enough competent case workers and supervisors to respond to reports of abuse or neglect and to provide ongoing case monitoring. Education in parenting is lacking and an important need to fulfill, especially related to the responsibilities of fatherhood. Recruiting and securing commitments from caring foster care parents is very important. Some good news is that, according to the N.Y. City Administration for Children's Services, they have improved their ratio of Child Protective Specialists/Case Workers to better than 1:12 for family cases in N.Y. City and in some situations, where cases are more critical, the ratio of Child Protective Specialists to families is as low as 1:8 or 1:4. Even considering the City budget difficulties due to the negative economic effects and public health strains due to COVID-19 in 2020 and 2021, it is important that funding for the Administration for Children's Services be maintained at sufficient levels to provide a good ratio of case workers to victims of abuse, and to continue to prioritize needed child protection, and abuse prevention services.

After School, Evening and Weekend Youth Programs are critically important to reduce youth delinquency and build self-esteem among children and teenagers. These valuable programs and activities are one of the main reasons that crime in New York City decreased significantly in the years before the COVID Pandemic started in 2020. Thankfully these programs and activities have been very well funded by City taxpayers in the past 10 years or more. With so many young people performing below grade level in reading and math, which has become more of an issue because of the COVID Pandemic, having after school tutoring provided by honest, competent not-for-profit organizations can significantly help students to perform better in school and succeed in life.

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## YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                           |
|--------|----------|-------------------------------------------------|
| DOE    | 1 / 1    | Create Additional Childcare Centers             |
| SCA    | 1 / 1    | Provide a new or expand an existing high school |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                                     |
|--------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ACS    | 1 / 1    | Fund an ACS Satellite Office in Queens                                                    |
| DYCD   | 1 / 1    | Provide, expand, or enhance after school programs for middle school students (grades 6-8) |

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

#### **General crime**

While crime had been reduced greatly in NYC during the past 2 decades, prior to 2020, crime has increased significantly in the past 4 years. Our dedicated 104th Police Precinct officers and supervisors are very busy answering 911 calls and 311 calls, especially on the 4pm-Midnights Tour and the Midnights to 8am Tour. A very serious concern is that there are currently fewer than 130 Police Officers, exclusive of Supervisors, working in the 104 Police Precinct. A critical concern is how often Police need to respond to situations related to the possibility of domestic violence. Other problems, which Police often can't give sufficient attention to, include too many drivers speeding and not giving pedestrians respect, illegal truck traffic, problem party venues, and illegal parking. Officers and Supervisors in the 104th Police Precinct have been stressed even more, and resources have been drained, due to assaults and other problems related to the men's shelter on Cooper Avenue in Glendale. In 2020, crime escalated throughout the City of New York. Shootings and murders skyrocketed in many parts of Our City in 2020, which is the year of Bail Reform, the Coronavirus (COVID-19) and the tragic killing of George Floyd in Minneapolis by a Police Officer. There have been hundreds of protests, which in Our City have mostly been peaceful, but there have been instances of abuse of Police Officers and looting.

Relationships between Police Departments and residents in many of our inner cities nationally needs to improve. And real discussion and Police efforts to diminish the relatively small number of Police Officers who are causing unnecessary deaths and abuse of residents needs to be accomplished. It is very important to remember that dedicated Police Officers and Supervisors have much stress in performing their jobs. They bravely protect lives and property throughout Our City and Nation, and should be respected.

In the 104th Police Precinct, which covers Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale in Queens, major index crime rose more than 30% during 2022. We need new Police Academy Classes to begin training, to replenish the NYC Police force who are retiring more than expected. NYPD efforts to recruit, beginning in high school, could help efforts to obtain good candidates. Well trained anti-crime police officers and supervisors are needed to catch criminals carrying weapons, especially guns. It is imperative that we not have a revolving door for criminals in the judicial system. Too many people with histories of committing crime have been released soon after they were arrested. Judges need to be able and willing to order violent criminals and recidivist perpetrators of crime to be kept in jail.

We need a judicial system that is much more efficient, so that those awaiting trial do not spend far too many months in jail on Rikers Island, where they too often become more hardened criminals. We also need jail and prison systems that do much better at reforming criminals.

### Community District Needs Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

#### **Needs for Public Safety**

Some capital improvements have been performed at the 104th Police Precinct, including: a new roof, boiler replacement, some plumbing system upgrades, renovation of locker rooms, bathrooms and a new assembly room. Additional improvements needed are: upgrades to the old, often malfunctioning waste system, upgrades to the supervisor's bathroom on the first floor and the 2nd floor male bathroom, upgrades to the prisoner's bathroom, replacement of deteriorated and dangerous windows posing a safety hazard, expanding the female supervisor's locker room, providing access for the handicapped, refurbishing the main desk, correcting the problem of leaks

in the basement, a new garage compressor so that Police vehicle tires can be filled on-site, installation of cameras for the area on Shaler where evidence and accident vehicles are stored and painting the entire precinct.

Until recently, crime has increased significantly in our city. Violent crime, robbery and quality of life remain the first concern of most New Yorkers. Efforts to win the crime war have included, acquiring the Robbery Identification Unit at the 104th Precinct, advocacy for more police officers and communities working with those police officers, removal of a great deal of graffiti from buildings, and providing after school and weekend education, sports and recreation programs. The residents of the Community Board 5, Queens area need the following resources and the police cooperation to effectively fight crime in the areas served by the 104th Precinct: 170 Police Officers; 21 Sergeants; 7 Lieutenants; 2 Captains , Robbery ID Unit, considering Bushwick border and commercial areas, a well run Precinct Detective Unit ; Sufficient, well conditioned patrol vehicles, scooters, bicycles, 4-wheel drive vehicles and vans for Police to effectively patrol.

To reduce crime now and into the future, some of the needs include: Better attentiveness to juvenile crime, stiff prison sentences for the most violent criminals, and more structured detention for auto thieves, pickpockets and substance abusers, long-term prison sentences for those convicted of dealing in quantities of heroin, crack and other hard drugs, attention to the physical condition of the 104th Police Precinct and the morale of the officers, who do not work in the most enviable conditions. Illegal truck traffic continues to create dangers throughout our city. This problem needs more attention from the NYPD, DOT and other responsible agencies.

### **Needs for Emergency Services**

The condition of buildings that serve Fire Department Engine Companies and Ladder Companies is critical. An example of problems that can arise from lack of capital improvement to fire houses has been seen most recently when the fire companies located at the house on Grand Avenue, just west of Queens Boulevard in Elmhurst, had to be relocated. It is imperative that capital improvements to the structures and apparatus floors of all fire houses be performed expeditiously, based on problems reported by engine and ladder companies and inspections done by qualified engineers. Regular ongoing replacement of Engine Company and Ladder Company fire fighting vehicles must be a City priority. To our knowledge, funding was available to provide Fire Department apparatus with exhaust connections that are state of the art, to provide minimal danger to firefighters' health in the fire houses. It is critical that these new exhaust connections be installed, and maintained, in all fire houses. Professional fire protection is absolutely essential in urban areas. The risk of reduced services in the Fire Department can be disastrous. Those living in Ridgewood and adjacent communities remember well when the nearby Bushwick, Brooklyn community was devastated by fire in the 1970's. Fire Prevention is an important concern. With the growing number of illegal occupancies in residential buildings, it is more important that the Fire Department play a greater role in curbing this problem. Often times a Building Department or Housing inspector cannot gain access to a building that has dangerous conditions or one or more illegal apartments, but access will less likely be refused to firefighters. There are also serious concerns about reductions in the number of firefighters that go out on each run to a fire scene, both planned and reductions that have already occurred (roster manning). This can endanger the public as well as the firefighters.

Emergency Medical Services (Ambulances) are a top priority of the members of Community Board 5, Queens. The time that it takes for an ambulance to get a person to the emergency room of a hospital can be the difference in life and death. Well trained EMS workers and properly maintained ambulances are of the utmost importance. We have been most fortunate to have the Ridgewood, Middle Village and Glendale Volunteer Ambulance Corps working in cooperation with EMS.

## PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                       |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------|
| NYPD   | 1 / 1    | Renovate or upgrade existing precinct house |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                       |
|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FDNY   | 1 / 2    | Provide funding for appropriate FDNY staffing                               |
| FDNY   | 2 / 2    | Provide funds for tools and equipment for local department personnel        |
| NYPD   | 1 / 2    | Hire additional uniformed officers                                          |
| NYPD   | 2 / 2    | Hire additional School Safety Officers, Crossing Guards, and Traffic Agents |



# CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

#### **Sewer capacity**

There has been extensive street and basements flooding in portions of District 5, Queens, during heavy rains. Considering ongoing environmental pressures globally and in the USA, where we have witnessed more violent weather in recent years, infrastructure upgrades are vital. On 8/8/2007, for instance, we had 4 plus inches of rain locally in 45 minutes. On 8/15/2012, we were flooded with 3 inches of storm water in just 30 minutes. On 8/7/2018, heavy rains caused extensive street and basement flooding in our communities. Most recently, on 9/1/2021, 6 inches of rain fell in portions of our City and in September, 2022 there was another heavy rainstorm in a short period of time. As a result, significant parts of Glendale, Maspeth, Middle Village & even Ridgewood were overwhelmed by flooding. With forecasts of continued global warming, we better be well prepared. Solutions to flooding problems during moderate to heavy rainstorms are especially needed in the Glendale community, along 77 Avenue and 78 Avenue from 76 Street to 88 Street (SE 877). We urge the NY City Departments of Environmental Protection and Design and Construction to prioritize design and construction of this and other new sewer projects in this area of Glendale, especially considering that, during the heavy rainstorm of 9/1/2021, many homeowners along 77 Avenue, in Glendale, were overwhelmed with more than 2 feet of storm water in their basements.

During the past 7 years we have had 3 major sewers projects under construction in District 5, Queens, to eliminate or greatly reduce flooding conditions by providing greater sewers capacity. One of these sewers projects is in the Penelope Avenue/74 Street area of Middle Village, where, during heavy rains, many home basements had been flooded with more than a foot of storm water. This critical project was completed in 2020. Another significant sewers construction project is in the Calamus Avenue/69 Street area of Maspeth and Woodside, and this project was completed in 2019. More recently a micro-tunneling sewers project was completed in the 70th Street/Grand Avenue area, in Maspeth.

### Community District Needs Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

#### **Needs for Water, Sewers, and Environmental Protection**

Every effort must be made to maintain the high quality of the drinking water available to NY City residents. Travelling to other localities, City residents can take pride in the fact that they can still "turn on the tap" and pour an excellent glass of drinking water. Completion of the Third Water Tunnel and the system that will bring water from this tunnel to residents and businesses is very important. Many of us were fearful of plans for hydrofracking in New York State, which could have disastrous effects on our prized drinking water and environment. The effects of this high volume deep drilling for energy sources has ruined the environment severely in other states. Hydrofracking plans may pose one of the greatest threats to our environment in our lifetime. Thank goodness fracking is now banned in N.Y. State.

While the water system in our City is quite good, the sewer system is another matter entirely. Cave-in conditions on local streets and main arteries are very often caused by sewer line breaks or problems with manhole structures. Sunken and broken corner catch basins can go unrepaired for months at a time. The Community Board consistently reports clogged catch basins and sewer lines that need to be cleaned and flushed. The City must make the repair of broken sewer lines, fire hydrants and catch basins a significant priority, and catch basin cleaning needs to be performed on

a more regular basis, considering global warming threats and the likelihood of severe rain storms more regularly. Personnel to perform this work must be hired. Efforts to get the public and businesses to stop littering and dumping into catch basins are important.

Air pollution and noise pollution are important concerns as well. Part of the solution is enforcement. Street tree plantings are a great means to reduce air pollution. An excellent public transit system is another important means of reducing air pollution, especially train service. Ongoing efforts are needed for building owners to upgrade to less polluting heating systems. We also need to have stringent regulations for truck emissions and for freight train emissions, as we do for our motor vehicles.

### **Needs for Sanitation Services**

Illegal dumping has become a terrible problem in our communities , and probably one of the primary reasons that businesses, especially manufacturers and distributors, have left the City for so called greener pastures. Thankfully, the Queens District 5 Sanitation force has done a great deal to get dumping locations cleaned as expeditiously as possible, given fairly limited resources. Sanitation Police 'stake-outs' of dumping sites must be a priority. Littering has also become a growing menace, as has the preponderance of residents who feel free to dump their household trash in and around the City litter baskets. The reason that Community Boards are consistently requesting that catch basins be cleaned and sewer lines flushed, in so many locations, is the degree of littering done in the catch basin and on the street.

For the most part, refuse and recycling collection is consistent and respectful in QW5. Snow removal had been quite efficient during the storms of recent years, but there were potentially serious snow accumulations that went unaddressed for days during the winter of 2015/2016. Mechanical broom sweeping of Ridgewood, parts of Maspeth and Glendale, along with the help of caring residents, keeps the area reasonably clean except where illegal dumping and litter occurs. Collection of sanitation litter baskets, on our busy commercial strips, needs to be performed 7 days a week. Recycling at schools is where many problems are caused in the community. Bagged food cans and other recyclables can't be stored in schools, so custodial staff put the bags on the sidewalks adjacent to the schools, causing an eyesore and encouraging illegal dumping. The Sanitation Department needs to schedule pick-ups for recyclables at many schools daily. Five-Day-A-Week School Garbage Collection is a top priority for District 5, in Queens. The QW5 area is still plagued with illegal dumping, primarily in out of the way areas (adjacent to the LIRR/CSX, and where industry must flourish). The Sanitation Department has successfully worked to diminish this once overwhelming scourge, but too often QW5 Sanitation staff must return time after time to clean up dump sites.

Too many of the people living in New York are abusing our city and this needs to change. Sanitation Police must give more priority to 'staking-out' dumping sites (especially between 10pm and 6am), seizing vehicles, getting dumpers fined, and publicizing the names of those convicted in major media. The installation of cameras near dumping locations can help deter this long-standing problem.

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## CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                                                                          |
|--------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DEP    | 1 / 3    | Other capital budget request for DEP (SEQ877)                                                                                  |
| DEP    | 2 / 3    | Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds |
| DEP    | 3 / 3    | Other capital budget request for DEP (Catch Basins)                                                                            |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                           |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DEP    | 1 / 2    | Provide field workers for Bureau of Water and Sewer Operations                  |
| DEP    | 2 / 2    | Hire operations staff for the Bureau of Wastewater Pollution Control            |
| DSNY   | 1 / 3    | Provide more staffing to address illegal dumping and litter basket collection   |
| DSNY   | 2 / 3    | Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions |
| DSNY   | 3 / 3    | Increase Sanitation Police and Enforcement Agents                               |

# HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

#### **Building code and/or zoning enforcement**

Building code enforcement continues to be one of our most important Expense Budget Priorities, since there are far too many residents living in illegal apartments and there are ongoing issues regarding construction without proper permits. In the past 9 years, the Ridgewood community has seen buildings purchased by speculators who have pushed tenants out or bought them out, so that they can obtain much higher rents. Affordable housing, especially for those renting, is a growing problem, most recently in Ridgewood where "runners" have reportedly gotten landlords to sell primarily 6 family houses, so that renovations can be made and rents can too often be doubled unfairly. Tenants, who have lived in these multiple dwellings for years, often decades, are being pushed out of their apartments. It is probably no small coincidence that there are approximately 250 people in the NYC homeless Shelter system, who give their last address as somewhere in the Community Board 5, Queens area.

The scenario seems to be that people get pushed out of their apartments, which were in today's times affordable, by speculators under questionable corporate disguises, and city taxpayers have to pay exorbitant costs to shelter more and more families and individuals. There is much that is terribly wrong, and possibly very corrupt with this story. This is all compounded by the fact that the Dept. of City Planning has achieved a M1 Hotels and Motels Zoning Text Amendment, which contains a provision for the use of properties zoned for manufacturing, for the so called public good.

Community Board 5, Queens has submitted a Proposed Rezoning of Ridgewood, Queens to the N.Y. City Dept. of City Planning, in an effort to better safeguard this pressured community from overdevelopment and development that is out- of- character with the surrounding community. Many of us thought that we had protected the community when Ridgewood was approved for contextual zoning changes back in 2000. But, with the housing market as hot as it is, some recent property owners are getting permits to add height to buildings in portions of Ridgewood that are part of the Ridgewood State and Federal Historic District, but have still not received protective N.Y. City Landmarks Status. Much more of Ridgewood should receive N.Y. City Landmarks Designation.

Employment is essential, if adults are to be capable of paying for food, housing, clothing, utilities and other essentials, and, of course, the development of quality businesses is vital so that those who are not the entrepreneurs have a place to earn a living. Efforts to give teens and young adults learning and skill opportunities, so that they can be gainfully employed, is critical. A good college education is important for most in our increasingly complex, competitive world, but college is not the best choice for everyone. Much more emphasis needs to be placed on giving teenagers and young adults an opportunity to learn valuable trades in high schools.

### Community District Needs Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

#### **Needs for Land Use**

One of biggest risks locally has become large party venues trying to open in buildings zoned for manufacturing. At 52-19 Flushing Av., in Maspeth, the property owner had applied for a cabaret liquor license to serve up to 5,000 patrons, at a large site that provided manufacturing employment for many years. Preliminary plans by the City Council and Mayor to safeguard manufacturing districts from these party place assaults need to become law. We have worked diligently with civic leaders and the Dept. of City Planning, during the past 15 years, to safeguard the character of the Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale communities. Our communities needed

protection from overdevelopment, which we thought was accomplished. The great majority of the Community Board 5, Queens area has obtained contextural zoning designations , but there are new overdevelopment pressures in our neighborhoods. While many areas of our Community Board area have been rezoned since 2000, more needs to be done to safeguard our communities from overdevelopment, and development that is out of character with the surrounding community. CB5Q has submitted proposals to the N.Y. City Dept. of City Planning to better safeguard the Myrtle Avenue and Fresh Pond Road commercial corridors, in Ridgewood, residential areas in Ridgewood and manufacturing areas. We have met with Dept. of City Planning representatives regarding our rezoning proposals and are hopeful that they will help us safeguard neighborhood character.

### **Needs for Housing**

Affordable housing is more at risk than anytime in decades, especially in the Ridgewood, Queens community. There has been a growing, greedy trend for the price of 6 family houses and multiple dwellings generally to be bid up by speculators. "Runners", representing clandestine investors, have reportedly gotten more and more property owners to sell buildings, at inflated prices , by forcing long-time tenants out and/or buying them out. Once the apartments can be renovated, our knowledge is that the property owner was able to recoup their investment in just 40 months, and the tenant's rent rose deplorably from \$1,000. monthly to more than double that amount. The Ridgewood community was known for affordable housing, especially in 6 family multiple dwelling buildings, but that was before speculators, operating under very questionable corporate disguises, pushed tenants out of their apartments. Greatly increased legal, legislative and enforcement efforts are needed to prevent landlords from harassing tenants, to increase penalties against landlords who stop providing essential services or who abuse tenants, and to provide legal services to tenants being harassed by greedy landlords or tenants at risk of losing their apartments.

It is important that affordable housing be maintained in rent stabilized buildings. There are many buildings in Ridgewood that have 6 apartments. Unfortunately, according to a March 1, 2023 article in The City publication, "the number of rent stabilized apartments registered in Ridgewood, Queens has plummeted. An analysis by The City shows that the number of rent stabilized apartments registered in Ridgewood plunged from 6,228 in 2019 to just 2,149 in 2021 - a decline of more than 65%, compared to a roughly 10% decline citywide." Why are so many apartments not registered as rent stabilized, in Ridgewood and other communities? How many of these apartments are no longer rent stabilized and why? The City and State administrations need to investigate and rectify all of this.

Senior housing is an important need, that is expected to grow by 40% by 2040. Seniors are living into their 70s and 80s more and more. A significant percentage of seniors live on limited income and are severely rent burdened, spending much more than 30 % of their income on rent. Our communities need senior housing that is not out of character with the neighboring community. Senior housing helps reduce feelings of isolation among the elderly and often improves mental well being.

### **Needs for Economic Development**

Probably a major reason that New York City has had significant problems balancing a budget revolves around the fact that manufacturing and non-service employment has declined astronomically during the past several decades. With this decline in manufacturing and non-service employment related jobs, the number of residents receiving public assistance had risen to alarming heights. The current administration should focus on job development and bring manufacturing back to our City. All too often, we hear about how the City has virtually given-up on the manufacturing sector to boost employment and the tax-base. This effort will no doubt require a great deal of cooperation with Federal and State government, but must be done. Community Board 5, Queens, in July, 2013 , overwhelmingly voted in favor of a Proposed Industrial Business Zone (IBZ) in the Ridgewood area, South of Myrtle Avenue, that is zoned M1-4 and M1-4D. This IBZ has been approved, and implementation of this IBZ designation should help to stabilize and increase manufacturing locally, with good marketing and coordination. In District 5, Queens, we once had

one of the largest concentrations of knitting mills in the United States. The knitting industry has historically been associated with the Ridgewood community. Locally, this very important industry has declined, but with the proper support, the garment manufacturing business in Ridgewood and other communities can flourish once again.

The West Maspeth Industrial Area is also very important to the community and our City. Retention of industry in this section of our community has always been a priority of Community Board 5. We have shown our commitment by consistently pushing for improved roadway and sewer conditions in this section of the community.

There are four major commercial streets in the Community Board 5, Queens area. Myrtle Avenue in Ridgewood and Glendale stretches from the Brooklyn border all the way to Cooper Avenue. Myrtle Avenue has seen a resurgence in recent years, thanks in large part to the efforts of the Ridgewood Local Development Corporation and the establishment of the Myrtle Avenue Business Improvement District, from Wyckoff Avenue to Fresh Pond Road, in Ridgewood. Grand Avenue in Maspeth, Fresh Pond Road in Ridgewood and Metropolitan Avenue in Middle Village are also important commercial strips. Community Board 5, Queens has important capital budget priorities, requesting capital budget funding for the Reconstruction of Sidewalks, Curbs and Pedestrian Ramps Along Myrtle Avenue, from Fresh Pond Road to Wyckoff Avenue; to Reconstruct Fresh Pond Road from Myrtle Avenue to Eliot Avenue; and to Improve the Myrtle Avenue Commercial Strip in Glendale. These budget priorities are listed in the Transportation Section (Section 8) of this Statement of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests.

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## HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                 |
|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HPD    | 1 / 1    | Establish a Contextual Senior Housing Residence in District 5, Queens |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                                   |
|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DOB    | 1 / 1    | Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)           |
| HPD    | 1 / 2    | Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations |
| HPD    | 2 / 2    | Increase funding for Community Consultant contracts                                     |



# TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Transportation and Mobility

#### **Traffic safety and enforcement (cars, scooters, ebikes, etc.)**

In a society where moving large numbers of people is so vital, public transportation, roads, bridges and traffic safety must be priorities. Traffic safety applies to each of these priorities in a broad sense, and, specifically related to the motor vehicle, our Community Board must consistently request traffic and pedestrian safety studies to safeguard pedestrians and attempt to calm motor vehicle and truck operators. Our community board has successfully led the effort to reconstruct or substantially renovate the train stations in the area we cover, and we have pushed for roadway resurfacing and reconstruction, including along Grand Avenue and Myrtle Avenue overnight; and we were very successful in the acquisition of new natural gas buses locally, but our most pressing matters are requests for traffic and pedestrian safety improvements.

Traffic congestion seems to be growing by the month. We are seeing the backups more than ever. The most difficult and dangerous intersections in District 5, Queens include Woodhaven Boulevard at Union Turnpike, Metropolitan Avenue at Fresh Pond Road, Myrtle Avenue at Wyckoff Avenue, Grand Avenue at 69 Street and both 69 Street and Grand Avenue at the Long Island Expressway Eastbound and Westbound Service Roads. The Eastbound Long Island Expressway is backed up until past 7pm many evenings. As a result of too many drivers selfishly speeding and not giving pedestrians their right-of-way, our Community Board submits dozens of requests each year, asking the NYC Dept. of Transportation to study streets to improve traffic and pedestrian safety. Traffic is named first, primarily due to the growing number of large and smaller motor vehicles traveling far exceeding the number of walkers during most of each hectic day. Having pushed for traffic signals and "All Way Stops" to better safeguard pedestrians and drivers, and succeeded in working with NYCDOT to see needs met, we have almost exhausted locations for these control devices. So, in more recent months, we are evaluating many more requests and study results for "Speed Bumps". Not many years ago, speed bumps were almost only installed in NY City on school blocks. Too many residents are fearful of more vehicles speeding along their residential blocks. Children playing in the street is an unfortunate distant memory.

### Community District Needs Related to Transportation and Mobility

#### **Needs for Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure**

The following are or should be priorities of the NYC/DOT: Allocate adequate resources for Traffic Safety Studies, Installation of All-Way Stops, One-Ways, Warning Signage, Traffic Signals, and Speed Bumps. , Doubling from one to two daily, the number of crews Queens Division of Road Repair sends out to repair serious roadway defects and pot holes, Having Arterial Highways free of dangerous conditions and cleaned more frequently, Make Roadway Resurfacing an on-going priority so as to greatly reduce the roads "rated 7 or worse", Improve Bridge Maintenance so that costly replacement does not become imminent, and Replace Deteriorated Bridge Structures (i.e. Grand Street Bridge Over Newtown Creek), Provide adequate numbers of Traffic Control Agents (NYPD) assigned to bridge entry points and other congested areas (especially major construction detour routes), and Reducing truck traffic problems throughout our City.

An important need has been Safer Passage for Pedestrians and Bicyclists to and from the Ridgewood Reservoir, which is a beautiful nature preserve in Highland Park, Needs included installation of sidewalks along portions of Cypress Avenue, between Cooper Avenue and Cypress Hills Street, and along Vermont Place from Cypress Avenue to Highland Boulevard. Conditions are dangerous because of the heavy traffic going to and from the Jackie Robinson Parkway. A bicycle

lane should also be considered, if it could be a safety improvement. Thankfully, a project to provide safer access to Highland Park and the Ridgewood Reservoir, along Vermont Place and Cypress Avenue, is almost complete.

### **Needs for Transit Services**

Ongoing Rehabilitation of our public transit system is critical to the health and vitality of the City of New York. If not for our extensive subway and elevated train line service, air pollution would be much worse and street traffic even more hazardous and gridlocked. Track beds, rails, signal systems, elevated line supports, platforms and stations must be upgraded, rehabilitated and maintained on an ongoing basis. The BMT-M elevated train line, the BMT-L and IND lines are the trains that primarily serve residents of the CB5Q area.

Specific capital improvement needs include: Reconstruct DeKalb Avenue, Halsey Street and Jefferson Street Train Stations (BMT-L Line). Only the Halsey Street Train Station is in Queens, but many of our Ridgewood residents either use these stations, or would use them, if they were not so deteriorated and if they were more inviting. An elevator is needed at the busy DeKalb Avenue station. Improve Myrtle/Wyckoff Transit Hub (to include overdue painting of the M Train Structure to prevent deterioration). There had been a great need for extensive Reconstruction of the BMT-L and BMT-M Train Transit Hub at Myrtle and Wyckoff Avenues, which had not been improved in decades. The long-awaited station reconstruction project finally began in 2005, and was completed in 2008. Unfortunately, until 2020 nothing had been done to repair and paint the elevated M Train structure, which is needed to prevent further deterioration and to enhance the M Line and station aesthetics.

We have seen the completion of an intermodal project for increased street lighting, a canopy for waiting bus riders and other improvements along Palmetto Street between Myrtle Avenue and St. Nicholas Avenue. This section of Palmetto Street is an integral part of the Myrtle/Wyckoff Transit Hub, where many City buses pick up and drop off commuters, as their first and last stop on the bus route.

Other important needs regarding public transportation include: Replace air-polluting diesel engine buses with new cleaner fuel and/or hybrid buses, Ongoing upgrades to train tracks, signal systems and switching systems. The revenues of the MTA and the N.Y. City Transit Authority have been down drastically, from Pre-COVID levels. There have been several Federal Stimulus packages to help reduce economic burdens for individuals, workers and businesses. The MTA has stated that we need at least another \$10 billion in short-term Federal Mass Transit Assistance, if there is hope of avoiding mass layoffs and severe reductions in public train and bus service. Public Transit is part of the economic lifeblood of New York City and surrounding localities, and our City and these localities are integral to the economic well-being of the U.S.A.

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## TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                     |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DOT    | 1 / 12   | Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps (Myrtle Avenue) |
| DOT    | 2 / 12   | Rehabilitate bridges (Cooper Avenue/71st Avenue)                          |
| DOT    | 3 / 12   | Reconstruct streets (Palmetto Street)                                     |
| DOT    | 4 / 12   | Reconstruct streets (HWK 876 - Wyckoff Avenue)                            |
| DOT    | 5 / 12   | Rehabilitate bridges (Grand Street/Grand Avenue)                          |
| DOT    | 6 / 12   | Green the Median of Woodhaven Boulevard                                   |
| DOT    | 7 / 12   | Reconstruct streets (Fresh Pond Road)                                     |
| DOT    | 8 / 12   | Reconstruct streets (HWQ 708 - South Middle Village Streets)              |
| DOT    | 9 / 12   | Reconstruct streets (Metropolitan Avenue/Woodhaven Boulevard)             |
| DOT    | 10 / 12  | Rehabilitate bridges (80th Street)                                        |
| DOT    | 11 / 12  | Other transportation infrastructure requests (Union Turnpike Mall)        |
| DOT    | 12 / 12  | Reconstruct streets (75th Street)                                         |
| NYCTA  | 1 / 2    | Other transit infrastructure requests (L Line Stations)                   |
| NYCTA  | 2 / 2    | Other transit infrastructure requests (LIRR)                              |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                         |
|--------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| DOT    | 1 / 3    | Fund additional street maintenance for roadways and curbs     |
| DOT    | 2 / 3    | Provide sufficient personnel funding to ensure traffic safety |
| DOT    | 3 / 3    | Improve arterial highways cleaning and maintenance            |

# PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

## Queens Community Board 5

### Most Important Issue Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

#### **Quality of parks and park facilities**

In an increasingly crowded city, where the great majority of those less affluent or economically struggling do not have access to much outdoor space, it is very important to have public parks that are in good physical condition, that are well maintained, inviting and that are respected by users. In the Community Board 5, Queens area, the Queens portion of Highland Park and Juniper Valley Park are our largest parks. The Ridgewood Reservoir, which is actually located in Glendale, is a beautiful natural oasis within Highland Park. The reservoir, which is no longer operating to provide drinking water, is more than 50 acres in size, and the closest space to a nature preserve that we have had anytime recently. Brooklyn Community Board 5, where approximately 20% of the Ridgewood Reservoir is located, have been very supportive of this beautiful site becoming the equivalent of a nature preserve. Community Board 5, Queens has avidly advocated for the Ridgewood Reservoir to receive Wetlands Status, which was accomplished in 2019. It is important that pedestrians and bicycle riders have safer access to the Ridgewood Reservoir and Highland Park. Juniper Valley Park, located in Middle Village, is more than 50 acres in size. This beautiful park contains 7 baseball fields (some of which are also used for softball play), 2 playgrounds, a large soccer field/football field surrounded by a running track, a roller hockey rink, bocce courts, basketball courts, a very active handball courts area, an asphalt softball field and beautiful green space. Juniper Park is utilized by youth and residents of Middle Village and numerous other communities.

Francis J. Principe Park (formerly Maurice Park), Reiff Park, and Frontera Park are the city parks primarily serving Maspeth residents. Ridgewood Parks include a portion of Mafera Park, Grover Cleveland Park, Rosemary's Playground, Benninger Park, and Starr Playground. Glendale Parks include a portion of Mafera Park, Evergreen Park, Vito Maranzano's Glendale Playground, Dry Harbor Playground, and Pinnocchio Playground. In addition to Juniper Valley Park, the Middle Village Community also contains Middle Village Playground.

We are very supportive of important capital projects for parks, and realize that parks safety and good parks maintenance are critically important for promoting healthy recreational activity, relaxation and community civility. Maintenance requires adequate personnel, and equipment that is in excellent condition. The following are important needs related to parks maintenance in Community District 5, Queens: - Having substantially more than 10 maintenance staff, including supervisors, for all of the parks in Q5. - A new Crew Cab is needed (double cabin pick-up truck), with plow attachment and motorized lift gate - A new Packer (Garbage Truck) is needed, as Q5 is a large district and the existing packer is too often in for repairs and is shared with Q6 Parks.

### Community District Needs Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

#### **Needs for Parks**

The condition of community parks and respect for parks and playgrounds is a vital need in a crowded city, where so many do not have access to outdoor space. In recent years, more parks are being reconstructed or upgraded, but many parks improvements have been capital budget priorities for many years prior to physical improvements beginning. Ongoing park reconstruction and renovation projects are needed to address deteriorated conditions, and to make parks more inviting to good residents. Parks are especially important to the positive development of children and teenagers physically, and, at least as important socially and psychologically.

Street tree plantings are needed to reduce air pollution, street heat and greatly beautify city streets and parks properties. Good trees maintenance is vital to prevent dangerous conditions, and to keep trees healthy. Maintenance of N.Y. City Parks should be more of a priority. Maintenance includes personnel and equipment. We need substantially more than 10 Parks Dept. Workers, including supervisors, to care for the many parks in Q5. A new Crew Cab is needed and a new Packer/Garbage Truck is long overdue for parks in District 5, Queens.

### **Needs for Cultural Services**

Although in District 5, Queens, we have few cultural facilities other than the historic Onderdonk House on Flushing Avenue, in Ridgewood, the great majority of us realize the importance of quality culture in an age when there are so many negative influences in music, movies and other so called modern culture mediums. Ongoing funding for needed repairs to the Onderdonk House and funding for maintenance of the building and property are an important investment in culture and for historic preservation.

### **Needs for Library Services**

Local libraries are an excellent source of learning and provide important information on a extensive range of subjects. Every effort should be made to upgrade libraries physically, to market the good that libraries have to offer (especially for children and teens), and to promote learning and research outside of the often standard, sometimes boring school day setting. As a society, we need to make learning much more enticing to young people, since there are too many entertainment distractions. These local libraries, more formally known as branch libraries, are important for providing access to the gift of reading related to many interesting subjects, and are also the scene for many good programs for children, youth and adults. Computers at libraries are well used by many who can not afford to have a computer at home. Having branch libraries open at least 6 days a week is a priority. There are 4 branch libraries located within the boundaries of Community District 5, Queens. The Ridgewood Library is located on Forest Avenue at Madison Street. The Maspeth Library is located on Grand Avenue, along the main shopping strip. The Middle Village Library is located on Metropolitan Avenue, just west of the main shopping strip. The historic Glendale Library, which was funded for extensive capital renovations that have finally been completed, is located on 73 Place at Myrtle Avenue. Community Board 5, Queens has a long history of successfully advocating for library improvements.

The Maspeth Library needs a new roof, but this funded project has been delayed for too long.

### **Needs for Community Boards**

Staff members at Community Boards, with the possible exception of District Managers, are often struggling economically. Many of them have worked diligently for more than a decade toward the stabilization of communities throughout NY City. I would like to see community boards receive a budget increase to give well deserved merit increases to deserving Board staff, many of who earn less than \$50,000. for full time work and then some. Regular funding increases are needed to enable Community Boards to purchase newer computers, photocopiers, printers, and supplies.

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## PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                                                      |
|--------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DPR    | 1 / 8    | Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Ridgewood Reservoir)                             |
| DPR    | 2 / 8    | Other street trees and forestry services requests (Street Tree Plantings/Stump Removals)   |
| DPR    | 3 / 8    | Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park (Mini Comfort Stations)           |
| DPR    | 4 / 8    | Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Juniper Valley Park)                             |
| DPR    | 5 / 8    | Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Dry Harbor Playground)                           |
| DPR    | 6 / 8    | Establish a Community/Recreation Center in Maspeth                                         |
| DPR    | 7 / 8    | Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park (Newtown Creek Aeration Property) |
| DPR    | 8 / 8    | Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Evergreen Park)                                  |
| DPR    | CS       | Reconstruct Mafera Park                                                                    |
| DPR    | CS       | Reconstruct Benninger Playground                                                           |

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

| Agency | Priority | Title                                                  |
|--------|----------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| DPR    | 1 / 3    | Hire Forestry personnel                                |
| DPR    | 2 / 3    | Need for more park maintenance personnel and equipment |
| DPR    | 3 / 3    | Increased Funding for Division of Forestry in Queens   |
| QL     | 1 / 1    | Provide seven day service at local libraries           |





# Community Board No. 5

Borough of Queens  
Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale  
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**Walter H. Sanchez**  
Chairperson

**Gary Giordano**  
District Manager

## EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS PROPOSED FOR NEW YORK CITY FISCAL YEAR 2027

### Item #                      PROJECT REQUESTED

1.                      **Redesign and Reconstruct Sewer System in Portions of CB5Q Area Having Worst Flooding Problems** – The main emphasis now needed is to achieve solutions to roadway and basement flooding during rainstorms for parts of the Glendale community, especially in the area of Cooper Avenue at 76 Street, and along 77 Avenue, from 76 Street to 88 Street. The storm on 9/1/2021 caused feet of water in basements! NYC DEP has originated Project#: SEQ877 to reduce flooding conditions in eastern Glendale. We look forward to the completion of design for this important project, so that installation of larger sewer lines can begin.  
  
                            **Responsible Agency:** Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] and Department of Design & Construction [DDC]
2.                      **Provide Stormwater Runoff Mitigation** – This request is for installation of green infrastructure to reduce the amount of stormwater runoff that has caused home and street flooding conditions, including along Myrtle Avenue, Grand Avenue, Metropolitan Avenue and Fresh Pond Road. Examples include rain gardens, aka bioswales, and permeable pavement installations.  
  
                            **Responsible Agency:** Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] and Department of Design & Construction [DDC]
3.                      **Reconstruct Sidewalks, Curbs and Pedestrian Ramps along Myrtle Avenue, from Fresh Pond Road to Wyckoff Avenue** – Sidewalks, with brick pavers, along Myrtle Avenue in Ridgewood have deteriorated, causing tripping hazards. One of the main problems has been tree roots lifting the bricks and the sidewalk flags. The last major improvement was in 1984/1985. This section of Myrtle Avenue receives extensive pedestrian traffic with people from Ridgewood and nearby communities shopping on Myrtle Avenue.  
                            Funding is needed to replace sidewalks and curbs along this section of Myrtle Avenue. There may also be a need to replace the city sewer and water main, which were not included in the 1984/1985 capital project. Other improvements requested include installation of historic street lighting on adjacent side streets.  
  
                            **Responsible Agency:** Department of Transportation [DOT], Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] & Department of Design & Construction [DDC]

– cont'd on Page 2 –



Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

- | <u>Item #</u> | <u>PROJECT REQUESTED</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.            | <p><b><u>Create Additional Childcare Centers</u></b> – There is a need for additional childcare in District 5, Queens, including Pre K and 3K Programs, but there is a lack of available programs considering unmet demand for childcare.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Education [DOE] &amp; Department of Health and Mental Hygiene [DOHMH]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 5.            | <p><b><u>Correct Cooper Avenue Underpass Flooding, Reconstruct the LIRR and 71<sup>st</sup> Avenue Bridge Abutments Above the Cooper Avenue Underpass, Reconstruct the Pedestrian Staircase and Paint the LIRR Bridge</u></b> – The Cooper Avenue Underpass is located on Cooper Avenue at approximately 76 Street. Reconstruction of the Cooper Avenue Underpass Retaining Walls has been completed (RWQ 005), at a cost of more than \$6 million. Unfortunately, this retaining wall project did not include reconstruction of the bridges abutments, the pedestrian staircase or painting the LIRR bridge. Solutions are also needed to reduce problems with the sewer line pump breaking down at this location, during rainstorms.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT], Department of Environmental Protection [DEP], Department of Design &amp; Construction [DDC], Metropolitan Transportation Authority [MTA], and the Long Island Railroad [LIRR]</p> |
| 6.            | <p><b><u>Reconstruct Palmetto Street from St. Nicholas Ave. to Seneca Ave., and from Onderdonk Avenue to Forest Avenue</u></b> – Palmetto Street serves as an important local artery, especially for numerous bus lines that take passengers to and from the Myrtle Avenue/Wyckoff Avenue Transit Hub. For the short term, parts of Palmetto Street were milled and resurfaced in the past year, as the roadway was in disrepair. Street conditions are complicated by the fact that the pillars supporting the elevated “M” Train are located in the bed of the roadway. A reconstruction project is still needed, considering the poor condition of sidewalks and curbs.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 7.            | <p><b><u>Construct New High Schools in Queens, including a New Trade/ Vocational High School</u></b> – This request includes Construction of New High Schools in Queens, including a new vocational high school, considering that many youth are very suited to a career in electrical, plumbing and other trades and there is significant demand for skilled workers. For years, there has been a shortage of high schools locally for Queens’s teenagers.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Education [DOE]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 8.            | <p><b><u>Rehabilitate the Ridgewood Reservoir – Phase II and the Surrounding Area, Including Portions of Highland Park</u></b> – This request includes the rehabilitation of the old pump house, or to construct a new building at the Ridgewood Reservoir site, to accommodate bathrooms and to serve as an Environmental Center, as the reservoir is the closest place to a nature preserve anywhere near the CB5Q area. Invasive plant species need to be removed in the beautiful reservoir basins. We are also requesting that funding be allocated to reconstruct ballfields in Highland Park, as CB5Q has opposed development of reservoir basins for ballfields.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [Parks]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

– cont’d on Page 3 –

Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

**Item #**                      **PROJECT REQUESTED**

**9.                      Provide New Street Tree Plantings and Provide Funding for Stump Removals, Planting of Replacement Trees and Street Tree Removals -**

The microburst that devastated portions of the CB5Q area on 9/16/2010 resulted in the loss of several hundred trees completely and has necessitated removal of dead trees, along with street tree stumps. Funding is needed to replace uprooted trees, for the removal and replacement of dead trees, for the removal of street tree stumps and for emergency pruning of dangerous street tree conditions. Hurricane Irene uprooted numerous additional trees. Consideration for new plantings should include: Grand Avenue, Metropolitan Avenue, Myrtle Avenue, Fresh Pond Road and Wyckoff Avenue.

CB5Q has, for decades, pushed for new street tree plantings, with much success. Street trees reduce air pollution and beautify City streets. Asthma and other respiratory problems are increasing. NYC must plant street trees at a much lower cost per tree!

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Parks & Recreation [**Parks**]

**10.                      Reconstruct Wyckoff Avenue, from Myrtle Avenue to Cooper Avenue –**

Wyckoff Avenue, on the Brooklyn/Queens border, is an important neighborhood artery with significant commercial development. This request is for reconstruction of the roadway and sidewalks, installation of new sewer lines and water mains from Myrtle Avenue to Cooper Avenue. The original project included Wyckoff Avenue, from Flushing Avenue to Cooper Avenue, but because of contamination at the Wolff-Alport Superfund Site, the portion from Myrtle Avenue to Cooper Avenue has been deleted from HWK876. For the short term, NYC DOT crews resurfaced Wyckoff Avenue in the past year.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Transportation [**DOT**], Department of Environmental Protection [**DEP**] & Department of Design & Construction [**DDC**]

**11.                      Reconstruct Deteriorated Catch Basins in the CB5Q Area and Provide New Catch Basins**

– The replacement of deteriorated brick catch basins, with precast concrete basins, is critically needed. In addition, we receive new basin requests to reduce street flooding. This need will continue.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Environmental Protection [**DEP**] and Department of Design & Construction [**DDC**]

**12.                      Reconstruct DeKalb Avenue, Halsey Street and Jefferson Street BMT-L Train Stations**

– Only the Halsey St. station is in Queens, but many of our Ridgewood residents either use these stations or would use them if they were not so deteriorated and if they were more inviting. ADA accessibility is needed at these stations, especially at DeKalb Avenue. There is increased development along the Brooklyn/Queens border, and we need to ensure that these train stations are modernized and rehabilitated. We are informed that since 2012, the Halsey Street station had the largest percentage growth in passengers of any “L” train station.

**Responsible Agency:** New York City Transit [**NYCT**] and Metropolitan Transportation Authority [**MTA**]

Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

- | <u>Item #</u> | <u>PROJECT REQUESTED</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 13.           | <p><b><u>Install Mini Comfort Stations at Starr Playground, Benninger Park, Uncle Vito Maranzano's Glendale Playground and Juniper Valley Park</u></b> – Starr Playground is located on Onderdonk Avenue at Starr Street, Benninger Park is located on Madison Street, just west of Fresh Pond Road, and Uncle Vito Maranzano's Glendale Playground is located on Central Avenue at 70<sup>th</sup> Street, The Juniper Valley Park comfort station request is for the section located between 80<sup>th</sup> Street and Dry Harbor Road and Juniper Blvd. North and South. This request is for the installation of mini comfort stations at each of these Parks Department properties.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [<b>Parks</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 14.           | <p><b><u>Replace Existing Bridge on Grand Ave over Newtown Creek in Maspeth</u></b> – Due to the deteriorated conditions of this 2-lane bridge, which only worsened in the aftermath of Super Storm Sandy in 2012, and the increased vehicular traffic over this bridge, replacement of the existing bridge over Newtown Creek in the Maspeth Industrial Area is needed. The bridge has been closed numerous weekend days for repairs. This vital bridge, built in 1905, connects Queens and Brooklyn.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [<b>DOT</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 15.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct the Lower Ballfields (fields 2 and 4) in Juniper Valley Park</u></b> – These baseball fields are deteriorated, are not usable for days after even moderate rains and need reconstruction, with consideration for these fields also being used for soccer. Thankfully, Fields 1 and 3 were upgraded in the past 2 years by the NY Mets.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [<b>Parks</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 16.           | <p><b><u>Replace or Repower Polluting Stage Zero Freight Engines Hauling NYC Municipal Waste Through District 5, Queens</u></b> – The use of freight rail has increased tremendously in recent years, but the communities of Glendale, Middle Village, Ridgewood and Maspeth have suffered as a result. Conditions are compounded considering that the amount of NY City municipal waste scheduled for freight transport is scheduled to grow greatly with the expansion of the Review Avenue Transfer Facility in the CB2Q area.</p> <p>This request is for the replacement or repowering of the very old stage zero locomotives, leased by New York and Atlantic Railway from the LIRR/MTA, with Tier 4 Switch Duty Cycle locomotives. These old locomotives are polluting our communities and other communities. 2 of the 11 old freight locomotives used locally have been replaced and \$20 million of additional funding is available thanks to State funding obtained by Assembly Member Hevesi and other local State elected officials.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Long Island Railroad [<b>LIRR</b>] and Metropolitan Transportation Authority [<b>MTA</b>]</p> |
| 17.           | <p><b><u>Provide Plantings on the Concrete Median of Woodhaven Boulevard between Eliot Avenue and the intersection with Cooper Avenue/Yellowstone Blvd.</u></b> – The concrete median would better serve the public as a planted median that could absorb rainwater runoff and host other plantings to beautify the community</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [<b>DOT</b>], Department of Environmental Protection [<b>DEP</b>] &amp; Department of Design &amp; Construction [<b>DDC</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

– cont'd on Page 5 –

Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

- | <u>Item #</u> | <u>PROJECT REQUESTED</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 18.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct Dry Harbor Playground - Phase II to Also Include Nearby Tunnel and Pathways</u></b> – This City Park is located on Myrtle Avenue at 80<sup>th</sup> Street, and is the only park for eastern Glendale. This Phase II Request is for rehabilitation of the asphalt softball field and the park house/bathrooms. The reconstruction of the children's playground is completed.</p> <p>Funding is also needed to rehabilitate the tunnel and the bicycle path under the Jackie Robinson Parkway, and the connecting bicycle/golf cart pathway to its easterly connecting point of Forest Park Drive. Drainage, signage and lighting improvements are important along these pathways.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [<b>Parks</b>]</p> |
| 19.           | <p><b><u>Establish a Community/Recreational Center at a Site in Maspeth</u></b> – The communities comprising District 5, Queens, do not have large indoor public space, other than schools, for recreation and community activities. The Executive Committee would like to find a vacant site in Maspeth for a community/recreational center.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Various (including the Dept.of Parks and Recreation)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 20.           | <p><b><u>Rehabilitate the 104<sup>th</sup> Police Precinct Interior</u></b> – The 104<sup>th</sup> Precinct station house is an old building and ongoing improvements needed include: heating system upgrades, plumbing upgrades (including waste lines, supervisor's bathroom on the 1<sup>st</sup> floor, 2<sup>nd</sup> floor male bathroom, and prisoner bathroom), window replacements, providing an ADA accessible entrance, fixing basement leaks which pose unhealthy conditions, central air conditioning, and refurbishing the main desk.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Police Department [<b>NYPD</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 21.           | <p><b><u>Provide Safe Public Access to Newtown Creek and Construct an Athletic Field at the NYC DEP Newtown Creek Aeration Facility Property</u></b> – The NYC DEP has built an aeration facility at 58-16 47<sup>th</sup> Street, in an effort to improve Newtown Creek water quality. Local soccer users have requested that the land owned by the City, adjacent to the aeration facility, be developed as an athletic field because there is a shortage of space where soccer can be safely played.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Environmental Protection [<b>DEP</b>], Department of Design &amp; Construction [<b>DDC</b>], and Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [<b>Parks</b>]</p>                                                                                 |
| 22.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct Evergreen Park – Phase III</u></b> – This request is for reconstruction of the asphalt softball field. This park is located on St. Felix Avenue, between 60<sup>th</sup> Place and 60<sup>th</sup> Street, in Glendale, and is adjacent to PS 68.</p> <p>Thanks to funding primarily secured by Council Member Robert Holden this project is funded and should proceed to construction soon.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Parks &amp; Recreation [<b>Parks</b>]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

- | <u>Item #</u> | <u>PROJECT REQUESTED</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 23.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct Fresh Pond Road from Myrtle Ave. to Eliot Ave., and Provide Traffic Facilitation Improvements</u></b> – Fresh Pond Rd. is a major north/south artery in the CB5Q area. This request includes planning/implementation of better traffic facilitation, by cutting into curb areas (where possible) to enable trucks and buses to get to the curb. For the short term, NYC DOT had Fresh Pond Road resurfaced in 2019.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT], Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] &amp; Department of Design &amp; Construction [DDC]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 24.           | <p><b><u>Establish a Contextual Senior Housing Facility in QCB5</u></b> – There is a need for affordable housing for seniors in District 5, Queens. Many older adults have little or no income other than Social Security and apartment rents are now not affordable. Senior housing is needed that does not disturb neighborhood character.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Housing Preservation &amp; Development [HPD] Department for the Aging [DFTA]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 25.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct South Middle Village Streets</u></b> – Reconstruction of the Cooper Avenue North Service Road, into 71<sup>st</sup> Avenue (along the LIRR) and 73<sup>rd</sup> Place, from Metropolitan Avenue to the LIRR/70<sup>th</sup> Avenue, are the most important parts of this area-wide project. This long-awaited project, that was scheduled for FY 2013, has now been pushed back, but we must continue to advocate for the project to be done. As a short-term measure, the NYC DOT Bureau of Highways has resurfaced 73<sup>rd</sup> Place, between Metropolitan Avenue and 70<sup>th</sup> Avenue, and several other area roads were resurfaced in 2015 and in 2020.</p> <p>This area wide project will include replacement of water mains, sewer lines, sidewalks, curbs, street lighting and roadway reconstruction for all the streets in the area bordered by: Metropolitan Avenue to the north, the LIRR and the Cooper Avenue North Service Road to the south, 80<sup>th</sup> Street to the east and 73<sup>rd</sup> Place to the west (but not including Metropolitan Avenue and 80<sup>th</sup> Street).</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT], Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] &amp; Department of Design &amp; Construction [DDC]</p> |
| 26.           | <p><b><u>Extend Street/Roadway Widening along the South Side of Metropolitan Ave. - Woodhaven Blvd. to Aubrey Avenue</u></b> – Some roadway widening was done, just west of Woodhaven Blvd., when Home Depot came to the area, but more needs to be done to reduce traffic back-ups, especially considering the commercial development at nearby Atlas Terminals. This need is even greater now that several large chain stores have opened on Metropolitan Avenue, east of Woodhaven Boulevard, and the Metropolitan High School has been in session for 12 years.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

Queens Community Board 5  
EXPLANATION OF CAPITAL PROJECT REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027

- | <u>Item #</u> | <u>PROJECT REQUESTED</u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 27.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct the East Sidewalk of 80<sup>th</sup> Street, on the 80<sup>th</sup> Street Bridge, Over the LIRR, and Review the Structural Stability of the Bridge</u></b> – Pedestrians have to walk a narrow sidewalk to get to and from the Atlas Park Shopping Center. The roadway over the 80<sup>th</sup> Street Bridge in Glendale should be wide enough to allow sidewalk expansion and reduce dangerous conditions for pedestrians.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT]</p>                |
| 28.           | <p><b><u>Provide Historic Street Lighting and Restore Deteriorated Curbing Along Fred Haller's Union Turnpike Mall (Myrtle Avenue to Woodhaven Blvd)</u></b> – Union Turnpike is a wide residential roadway, and is one of the gateways into the CB5Q area. Improvements needed include new curbing, tree root pruning and new decorative, historic LED lighting. This project was partially funded, and new pavement has been installed along the center median.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT]</p> |
| 29.           | <p><b><u>Reconstruct 75<sup>th</sup> Street from Eliot Ave. to Juniper Blvd. No.</u></b> – Although NYC DOT Bureau of Highways crews have resurfaced 75<sup>th</sup> St. in the past 12 years, it is quite evident that this street needs reconstruction. Parts of the roadway are as high as the sidewalks on this block.</p> <p><b>Responsible Agency:</b> Department of Transportation [DOT], Department of Environmental Protection [DEP] &amp; Department of Design &amp; Construction [DDC]</p>                                      |



# Community Board No. 5

Borough of Queens  
Ridgewood, Maspeth, Middle Village and Glendale  
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**Walter H. Sanchez**  
Chairperson

**Gary Giordano**  
District Manager

## EXPLANATION OF EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS PROPOSED FOR NEW YORK CITY FISCAL YEAR 2027

### Priority Project Request

#### **1 Provide Field Workers for Bureau of Water and Sewer Operations**

Field workers in sufficient numbers are needed to ensure that City water remains excellent; that catch basins are cleaned and repaired and sewer lines are flushed in a reasonable amount of time; that sewer backups and leaks are corrected expeditiously; and that sewer repairs and fire hydrant repairs are performed in a timely manner. Cave-in conditions in the road and adjacent to catch basins too often have gone unrepaired for months, presenting dangerous conditions.

**Responsible Agency:** Dept. of Environmental Protection [DEP]

#### **2 Provide Needed Services for Senior Citizens**

Community District 5, Queens has a very large senior citizen population, many of whom are frail, without adequate care and living alone. The following are necessary programs to meet some of the needs of senior citizens: 1) Provide adequate funding for Meals-On-Wheels Programs; 2) Provide adequate funding for congregate meals programs; 3) Provide funding for senior transportation programs; 4) Fund Health Care Programs for the Elderly and Senior Home Care; and 5) Fund Emergency Food Programs for Seniors.

**Responsible Agency:** Department for the Aging [DFTA]

#### **3 Provide More Sanitation Department Cleaning Personnel, to Clean Illegal Dumping and for Litter Basket Collections**

Illegal dumping and garbage drop-off locations are a consistent problem in District 5, Queens. In order to alleviate these very problematic conditions, which are potential health hazards and hamper business investment: 1. Restore Clean Team personnel to clean dump-out and drop-off locations on a regular basis, 2. Provide adequate personnel to empty litter baskets 7 days a week.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Sanitation [DSNY]

- Cont'd on Page 2 -



**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET PRIORITIES  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**4                    Provide Funding for Educational and Recreational Programs for Children and Teens**

After school, evening and weekend delinquency prevention programs should be maintained locally. This is especially critical at a time when far too many children and teenagers are unsupervised by parents or guardians after the school day ends and on weekends. These programs are very critical as they increase self-esteem levels of participants, thereby preventing substance abuse and delinquent behavior. While Beacon Programs are welcome, it is vital that funding for other quality "local" education and recreation programs be a priority. Thankfully, recent Mayors and City Council Members have increased youth program funding substantially.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Youth & Community Development [DYCD]

**5                    Hire Inspectors and Plan Examiners, in Sufficient Numbers, to Cope with Illegal Uses of Property and Questionable Construction**

A separate afternoon/evening and weekend inspection team of 10 inspectors for Queens is critical because inspectors very often can't gain access in the daytime during the work-week. Communities throughout Queens have been plagued with illegal apartments posing dangerous conditions, school overcrowding and more pressure on limited City services. Construction inspectors and plan examiners in adequate numbers are needed to curtail contractors building homes larger than the zoning permits. Currently, to our knowledge, Queens has only 26 plan examiners and only 15 construction inspectors, including supervisors, usually working in the borough.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Buildings [DOB]

**6                    Provide Funding for Fire Department Services**

Funding is needed for the following essential Fire Department Services: maintain engine companies and ladder companies at current staffing levels; provide funding for the Department's Building Unit; ensure adequate staffing for excellent maintenance of FDNY apparatus and other vehicles; and provide sufficient funding for the Fire Safety Education Unit. Priority should also be given to hiring a sufficient number of EMS staff to cope with increased needs for the life-saving services that they provide in our city.

**Responsible Agency:** Fire Department [FDNY]

**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**7                    Hire Forestry Personnel**

With previous cuts, the Forestry Division had been decimated. At one point, there were only 4 climbers and pruners to care for more than 327,000 street trees in Queens. Queens needs at least 55 climbers and pruners to remove and prune trees posing dangerous conditions.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Parks & Recreation [**Parks**]

**8                    Fund Additional Street Maintenance for Queens Roadways and Curbs**

In order to have roadways and curbs along commercial strips and in residential communities repaired before dangerous conditions arise, the following requests need to be funded: provide one crew for cave-in repair; 2 crews for pothole repairs; 1 crew for concrete repair; 2 crews for curb replacement; and 1 crew for miscellaneous maintenance (ponding conditions, etc.) daily for Queens. Lawsuits against the City might be greatly reduced if repairs could be done more promptly.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Transportation [**DOT**]

**9                    Assign Additional Personnel for the 104th Police Precinct Patrol Force**

Within the last 12 years, the patrol strength of the 104th Pct. has dropped under 130 officers. At least 170 officers are needed for the 104th Pct., plus supervisors, to cope with robbery, burglary, felony assaults, some violent crime, domestic violence, scams, some inadequate response times, vehicular speeding, much illegal parking, auto theft and rowdy conditions often caused by substance abuse.

**Responsible Agency:** Police Department [**NYPD**]

**10                  Continue 5 Times Per Week Garbage Collection and Begin 5 Day a Week Recycling Collection at Schools**

The reduction to 2 days per week garbage collection caused unsanitary conditions around many local schools. School collection, 5 days per week, is critical during the school year and during the Summer. It is also important that recycling collection at schools be increased. Five times a week recycling collection is needed for many public schools, as the current conditions result in recyclables crowding school sidewalks.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Sanitation [**DSNY**]

**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NY CITY FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**11                    Provide Seven-Day-a-Week Service at Local Libraries**

Increased educational demands on students, the fact that many families cannot afford the internet or up-to-date computers and increasing immigrant populations necessitate that more local/branch libraries be open 7-days a week. Having Libraries open on Saturdays and Sundays is especially important to many residents!

**Responsible Agency:** Queens Borough Public Library [QPL]

**12                    Assign More Personnel and Equipment for Maintenance of Parks in District 5, Queens**

More park workers are needed to meet work requirements for the cleaning and maintenance of the 229.7 acres of parks in CD5Q. Currently, there are only 10 Parks Dept. maintenance staff, including supervisors, assigned for this massive parkland. Skilled maintenance workers (there are only 2 for all of Queens Districts 5, 9, 10 & Forest Park) should be funded year-round. Reseeding, aerating and fertilizing ball fields and grassy areas need to be priorities so that large capital expenditures are not wasted. Funding is also needed to hire more seasonal workers. Long Standing vehicle needs include a new Crew Cab and a new Packer. The packer consistently breaks down.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Parks & Recreation [Parks]

**13                    Allocate Funding for the Operation and Enhancement of the Division of Forestry in Queens**

There are extensive needs for pruning of trees on city streets and in city parks, which are too numerous for the Division of Forestry to keep up with. There are currently thousands of street tree stumps that need to be removed in Queens. The following budget allocations are needed to address these conditions, and the need to remove dead trees and limbs on an emergency basis: \$4.5 Million for county-wide pruning contract; \$3.5 Million for removal of tree stumps in Queens; \$2 Million for removal of dead trees and limbs. Trees are aging, and risks of falling tree limbs and dead trees pose dangerous conditions.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Parks & Recreation [Parks]

**14                    Provide Sufficient Personnel for Traffic Safety Inspections, Sign Installations, Pavement Markings and Sign Manufacturing**

Because of increasingly dangerous local traffic conditions, there has been a need during the past 10 years for more traffic safety studies, traffic signals, All Way Stop installations, Speed Bump installations, One Way Conversions, and No Parking designations to daylight intersections. Additional traffic device maintenance crews are needed for signage installation, pavement markings and sign manufacturing. Vehicles in good repair, including utility trucks, are needed to support current and projected staffing levels.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Transportation [DOT]

**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**15                    Hire Additional School Safety Officers, School Crossing Guards and Traffic Control Agents**

There are more School Safety Officers needed, especially at the intermediate school level, and School Safety Officers can reduce pressure for local precincts. In consideration of dangerous traffic conditions in and around schools, funding is needed to hire at least 5 additional school crossing guards for District 5, Queens schools. The City should earmark funding to hire additional traffic control agents: (Traffic Enforcement Agents-Level II), so that heavily travelled Queens intersections can be staffed. This will diminish the need to assign police officers, who are paid more.

**Responsible Agency:** Police Department [NYPD]

**16                    Increase the Number of Sanitation Police and Enforcement Agents, Especially in Plain Clothes, to Significantly Reduce Excessive Abuse of Litter Baskets and Illegal Dumping**

Because of previous layoffs, there are now fewer Sanitation Police citywide for illegal dumping. Sanitation Police positions should be greatly increased for illegal dumping, especially since they are revenue producing, and dumping is severely hurting communities. One SEA agent is needed daily in Q5. Severe fines, vehicle impoundments and more publicity, such as frequent press releases to TV and radio stations and major newspapers, are needed to make an example of dumpers and curtail illegal dumping. Installation of more cameras is needed to identify the dumpers. The abuse of litter baskets on commercial strips has become deplorable and needs to be better addressed.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Sanitation [DSNY]

**17                    Provide Funding for Rental Assistance Programs to Combat Homelessness**

Consistent, adequate funding is needed for programs such as the Living in Communities Rental Assistance Program (LINC), to prevent people from becoming homeless, and to move people from shelters to more permanent Housing.

**Responsible Agency:** Human Resources Administration [HRA] and Department of Homeless Services [DHS]

**18                    Allocate Funding for Dept. of Housing Preservation & Development Programs**

Adequate funding must be appropriated to cope with illegal residential property uses, deteriorating housing stock, and harassment of tenants by greedy landlords. The needs include HPD Code Enforcement Inspectors; funding for housing rehabilitation loan programs; substantial funding for tenant legal services, and for demolition and seal up operations in Queens. Currently, to our knowledge, only 29 Inspectors are assigned to Queens of 338 HPD Inspectors working in N.Y. City.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Housing Preservation & Development [HPD]

- Cont'd on Page 6 -

**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**19                    Hire Additional Personnel for Pest Control to Reduce the Enormous Rat Population in our City**

The Borough of Queens has too few staff to adequately address the rodent infestation problem, which has increased with the growth of dump-out locations and vacant properties. A minimum of 4 additional inspectors and 4 additional staff to bait are needed for Queens.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Health and Mental Hygiene [DOHMH]

**20                    Continue Funding of the Ridgewood Medical Center, Now Renamed Gotham Health/Cumberland**

The Ridgewood Medical Center (formerly known as the Maspeth Child Health Station and Ridgewood Communicare Health Center) provides important health services to many children, families and senior citizens. Ridgewood and neighboring communities have seen an increase in the number of people struggling economically. The need to expand services beyond the hours of Mon. to Fri., 8:30am to 4:30pm, should be seriously considered to serve workers and workers with children.

**Responsible Agency:** Health and Hospitals Corporation [HHC]

**21                    Hire Operations Staff for the Bureau of Wastewater Pollution Control**

Sufficient Staffing is needed to perform odor and water pollution control monitoring at wastewater treatment facilities in New York City. Odors from wastewater treatment facilities pose health hazards, will likely cause residents to move and could severely hamper business investment. Locally, we are most concerned about the Newtown Creek Water Pollution Control Plant.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Environmental Protection [DEP]

**22                    Provide Funds for: Tools and Equipment for Local Fire Department Personnel and for Fire Prevention Program Supplies**

Hurst Tools, Rabbit Tools, defibrillators, power saws, first aid equipment, etc., are needed to ensure the safety of residents and workers. Funding for Fire Fighters' face pieces is also an important need. Funding is also requested to purchase 10,000 smoke detectors, at a total cost of approximately \$100,000, and 10,000 carbon monoxide detectors, at a cost of \$200,000 for distribution to the public throughout the year. Funding is requested to purchase 10,000 new CPR kits for public training and distribution.

**Responsible Agency:** Fire Department [FDNY]

- Cont'd on Page 7 -

**Queens Community Board 5  
EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS  
PROPOSED FOR NYC FISCAL YEAR 2027**

**23                    Fund Bureau of Child Welfare (B.C.W.) Satellite Office in Queens**

There is a need for a Bureau of Child Welfare satellite office, especially during the 6 p.m. to 8 a.m. hours, to operate weekdays and weekends. Many children in the CB5Q area have sought sanctuary from abusive parents, relatives and other individuals. With B.C.W. staff hours limited, the abuse of children is too often unattended and the problem situation continues.

**Responsible Agency:** Administration for Children's Services [ACS]

**24                    Improve Arterial Highway Cleaning and Maintenance**

The conditions of arterial highways and their cleanliness should be a priority for the City and State of New York. Maintenance workers citywide are needed to repair and resurface roadbeds, repair and replace dividers, clean litter & debris, attend to growth, and eliminate graffiti in a timely manner.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Transportation [DOT] & Dept. of Sanitation [DSNY]

**25                    Increase Funding for Community Consultant Contracts**

In Q5, there are many multiple dwellings owned by landlords who need technical assistance related to leases, paperwork and tenant matters. Tenants are often in need of advice and assistance related to lease matters and landlords who do not upkeep property. In Q5, the Greater Ridgewood Restoration Corp. has a history of helping landlords and tenants. This organization has also prevented hundreds of properties from being taken from owners in lien sales, through excellent outreach to owners.

**Responsible Agency:** Department of Housing Preservation & Development [HPD]

## 6. ADDITIONAL COMMENTS AND OTHER BUDGET REQUESTS

Please find attached the Boards prioritized Capital Budget Requests and Expense Budget Priorities.

*Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.*

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

### EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.



## 7. SUMMARY OF PRIORITIZED BUDGET REQUESTS

### CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

#### 1 of 3 Other capital budget request for DEP (SEQ877)

DEP

Other capital budget request for DEP

Location: 77 Avenue - 76 Street & 88 Street  
REDESIGN AND RECONSTRUCT THE SEWER SYSTEM IN PORTIONS OF THE CB5Q AREA HAVING THE WORST FLOODING CONDITIONS (SEQ877)  
The main emphasis now needed is to achieve solutions to roadway and basement flooding during rainstorms for parts of the Glendale community, especially in the area of Cooper Avenue at 76 Street, and along 77 Avenue, from 76 Street to 88 Street (SE 877). Larger sewers are needed to prevent future household flooding from heavy rain storms. During the storm of 9/1/2021, homes along 77 Avenue were overwhelmed by more than 2 feet of water in basements.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

#### 2 of 3 Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds

DEP

Evaluate a public location or property for green infrastructure, e.g. rain gardens, stormwater greenstreets, green playgrounds

PROVIDE STORMWATER RUNOFF MITIGATION This request is for installation of green infrastructure, to reduce the amount of storm water runoff that has caused home and street flooding conditions, and to prevent storm water from overwhelming the city sewer system.. Examples include rain gardens, also known as bioswales, and permeable pavement installations.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

#### 3 of 3 Other capital budget request for DEP (Catch Basins)

DEP

Other capital budget request for DEP

RECONSTRUCT DETERIORATED CATCH BASINS IN THE QCB5 AREA AND PROVIDE NEW CATCH BASINS The replacement of deteriorated brick catch basins, with precast concrete basins, is critically needed. In addition, we consistently receive new basin requests to reduce street flooding. This need will continue, as catch basins are needed at new locations where there are significant ponding conditions.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

#### 1 of 1 Create Additional Childcare Centers

DOE

Other capital budget request for DOE

CREATE ADDITIONAL CHILDCARE CENTERS There is a need for additional childcare in District 5, Queens, including Pre-K and 3K Programs, but there is a lack of available programs considering unmet demand for childcare.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency does not/cannot give priority to funding this request.*

**1 of 12    Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps (Myrtle Avenue)****DOT**

Repair or construct sidewalks, curbs, or pedestrian ramps

Location: Myrtle Avenue - Fresh Pond Road & Wyckoff Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT SIDEWALKS, CURBS AND PEDESTRIAN RAMPS ALONG MYRTLE AVENUE, FROM FRESH POND ROAD TO WYCKOFF AVENUE, IN RIDGEWOOD Sidewalks, with brick pavers, along Myrtle Avenue in Ridgewood have deteriorated causing tripping hazards. One of the main problems has been tree roots lifting the bricks and the sidewalk flags. The last major improvement was in 1984/1985. This section of Myrtle Avenue receives extensive pedestrian traffic with people from Ridgewood and nearby communities shopping on Myrtle Avenue. Funding is needed to physically improve safety conditions along this section of Myrtle Avenue. There may also be a need to replace the main city sewer and water main in this section of Myrtle Avenue.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Further study by the agency of this request is needed.*

**2 of 12    Rehabilitate bridges (Cooper Avenue/71st Avenue)****DOT**

Rehabilitate bridges

Location: Cooper Avenue  
CORRECT COOPER AVENUE UNDERPASS FLOODING, RECONSTRUCT THE LIRR AND 71st AVENUE BRIDGE ABUTMENTS ABOVE THE COOPER AVENUE UNDERPASS AND PAINT THE LIRR BRIDGE The Cooper Ave Underpass is located on Cooper Ave at approximately 76 St. Reconstruction of the Cooper Avenue Underpass Retaining Walls has been completed (RWQ005), at a cost of more than \$6 million. Unfortunately, this retaining wall project did not solve the problem of this low part of Cooper Avenue flooding during rainstorms, did not include reconstruction of the bridge abutments, or painting the LIRR bridge. There is a city vehicular bridge and an LIRR Montauk Line Bridge above Cooper Avenue, in the area of 76 Street, in Glendale. The LIRR bridge is a rusted eyesore and needs to be repainted.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. This request has been addressed by NYC DEP.*

**3 of 12    Reconstruct streets (Palmetto Street)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Location: Palmetto Street - Saint Nicholas Avenue & Seneca Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT PALMETTO STREET FROM SAINT NICHOLAS AVENUE TO SENECA AVENUE, AND FROM ONDERDONK AVENUE TO FOREST AVENUE IN RIDGEWOOD Palmetto Street serves as an important local artery, especially for numerous bus lines that take passengers to and from the Myrtle and Wyckoff Avenues Transit Hub. For the short term, parts of Palmetto Street were milled and resurfaced in the past year as the roadway was in disrepair. Street conditions are complicated by the fact that the pillars supporting the elevated M train are located in the bed of the roadway. A reconstruction project is still needed, considering the poor condition of sidewalks and curbs.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. The agency will try to accommodate this issue within existing resources.*

**4 of 12 Reconstruct streets (HWK 876 - Wyckoff Avenue)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Location: Wyckoff Avenue - Flushing Avenue & Cooper Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT WYCKOFF AVENUE, FROM FLUSHING AVENUE TO COOPER AVENUE IN RIDGEWOOD (Queens and Brooklyn) - HWK 876. Wyckoff Avenue, on the Brooklyn-Queens border, is an important neighborhood artery with significant commercial development. This request is for reconstruction of the deteriorated roadway and sidewalks, installation of new sewer lines and water mains from Flushing Avenue to Cooper Avenue in Ridgewood. For the short term, Wyckoff Avenue was resurfaced from Myrtle Avenue to Cooper Avenue, because this part of Wyckoff Avenue has been removed from HWK876 due to contamination at the Wolff-Alport Superfund site. We look forward to this vital project beginning in 2026 for the area between Flushing Avenue and Myrtle Avenue. Part of Wyckoff Avenue is in the CB5Q area, and much of it is in Brooklyn Community District 4.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. The capital project within Brooklyn is ongoing. However, as noted the Queens segment was removed and improved via in-house resurfacing. Please contact the borough office if there are other specific concerns.*

**5 of 12 Rehabilitate bridges (Grand Street/Grand Avenue)****DOT**

Rehabilitate bridges

Location: Grand Street - 47 Street & 47 Street  
REPLACE THE EXISTING BRIDGE ON GRAND AVENUE OVER NEWTOWN IN MASPETH Due to the deteriorated conditions of this 2-lane bridge, which only worsened in the aftermath of Super Storm Sandy in 2012, and the increased vehicular traffic over this important bridge, replacement of the existing bridge over Newtown Creek in the Maspeth Industrial Area is needed. The Grand Street Bridge is too narrow to accommodate trucks and buses in opposite directions. Truckers and bus drivers have to wait for traffic to pass in the opposite direction, posing dangerous conditions and traffic delays. This vital bridge is deteriorating to the point where it is closed for repairs consistently. We look forward to this important bridge replacement beginning by 2027.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. DOT continues to maintain the bridge and move along with design for a rehabilitation/reconstruction of the structure. DOT will continue to brief CB 5 on progress.*

**6 of 12 Green the Median of Woodhaven Boulevard****DOT**

Repair or construct medians, or other street assets

Location: Woodhaven Boulevard - Eliot Avenue & Cooper Avenue  
PROVIDE PLANTINGS ON THE CONCRETE MEDIAN OF WOODHAVEN BOULEVARD BETWEEN ELIOT AVENUE AND THE INTERSECTION WITH COOPER AVENUE/YELLOWSTONE BOULEVARD The concrete median would better serve the public as a planted median that could absorb rainwater runoff and host other plantings to beautify the community.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. Capital design for Woodhaven Blvd is currently underway and this request will be taken into account where feasible.*

**7 of 12 Reconstruct streets (Fresh Pond Road)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Location: Fresh Pond Road - Myrtle Avenue & Eliot Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT FRESH POND ROAD FROM MYRTLE AVENUE TO ELIOT AVENUE, AND PROVIDE TRAFFIC FACILITATION IMPROVEMENTS Fresh Pond Road is a major north/south artery in the CB5Q area. This request includes planning/implementation of better traffic facilitation, by cutting into curb areas (where possible) to enable trucks and buses to get to the curb. For the short term, we succeeded in convincing NYC DOT Queens Street Maintenance supervisors to resurface Fresh Pond Road 5 years ago.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. The agency will try to accommodate this issue within existing resources.*

**8 of 12 Reconstruct streets (HWQ 708 - South Middle Village Streets)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

RECONSTRUCT SOUTH MIDDLE VILLAGE STREETS (HWQ 708) This long awaited project had been scheduled for FY 2013, but has been pushed back, but we must continue to advocate for the project to be moved up. As a short term measure, 73rd Place was resurfaced from Metropolitan Ave to 70 Ave., as were several other area roadways. This areawide project will include replacement of water mains, sewer lines, sidewalks, curbs, street lighting and roadway reconstruction of all streets bordered by Metropolitan Ave to the north, the LIRR and Cooper Ave. No. Service Rd to the South, 80 Street to the east and 73 Place to the west, not including Metropolitan Ave & 80 Street.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support but can address the need alternatively. DOT will continue to maintain these streets via in-house resources. Please log any specific concerns in the agency webform: <https://www.nyc.gov/html/dot/html/contact/contact-form.shtml>*

**9 of 12 Reconstruct streets (Metropolitan Avenue/Woodhaven Boulevard)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Location: Metropolitan Avenue - Woodhaven Boulevard & Aubrey Avenue  
EXTEND STREET/ROADWAY WIDENING ALONG THE SOUTH SIDE OF METROPOLITAN AVENUE, FROM WOODHAVEN BOULEVARD TO AUBREY AVENUE IN GLENDALE Some roadway widening was done, just west of Woodhaven Boulevard, when Home Depot opened on the east side of the Boulevard, but more needs to be done to reduce the traffic back-ups, especially considering the commercial development at nearby Atlas Terminals. The need is even greater now that several large chain stores have opened and are prospering on Metropolitan Avenue, east of Woodhaven Blvd and the Metropolitan High School has been in session for 11 years.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. DOT will continue to monitor conditions and look into possible traffic congestion mitigations.*

**10 of 12 Rehabilitate bridges (80th Street)****DOT**

Rehabilitate bridges

Location: 80 street - Cooper Avenue & 78th Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT AND WIDEN THE EAST SIDE OF 80TH STREET, ON THE 80TH STREET BRIDGE, OVER THE LIRR, IN GLENDALE AND REVIEW THE STRUCTURAL STABILITY OF THE BRIDGE Pedestrians have to walk a narrow sidewalk to get to and from the Atlas Park Shopping Center. The roadway over the 80th Street Bridge in Glendale should be wide enough to allow sidewalk expansion, and reduce dangerous conditions for pedestrians.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. DOT will consider this request in a future component rehab for this structure.*

**11 of 12 Other transportation infrastructure requests (Union Turnpike Mall)****DOT**

Other transportation infrastructure requests

Location: Union Turnpike - Woodhaven Boulevard & Myrtle Avenue  
PROVIDE HISTORIC LIGHTING AND RESTORE DETERIORATED CURBING ALONG FRED HALLER'S UNION TURNPIKE MALL (Myrtle Avenue to Woodhaven Boulevard). Union Turnpike is a wide residential roadway, and is one of the gateways into CB5Q. Improvements needed include new curbing, tree root pruning, and new decorative historic LED lighting. This project has been partially funded, and new pavement has been installed along the center median.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. Please contact your elected officials regarding possible funding allocations for distinctive lighting.*

**12 of 12    Reconstruct streets (75th Street)****DOT**

Reconstruct streets

Location: 75th Street - Eliot Avenue & Juniper Blvd. North  
RECONSTRUCT 75th STREET FROM ELIOT AVENUE TO JUNIPER BOULEVARD NORTH, IN MIDDLE VILLAGE Although the Bureau of Highways crews have resurfaced 75th Street in the past 12 years, it is quite evident that this street needs reconstruction. Due to extensive roadway and street settlement, resurfacing is but a short-term solution. The portion of the roadway adjacent to the Learning Tree Day Care Center is higher than the sidewalk, causing unhealthy water accumulation.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. After site reviews it was determined that the existing sidewalk is too low and has exacerbated ponding issues on the block. The private property owner should look into reconstructing and raising their sidewalk as per NYC Admin Code. Alternatively, we suggest contacting DEP for a possible bioswale review.*

**1 of 8    Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Ridgewood Reservoir)****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

REHABILITATE THE RIDGEWOOD RESERVOIR - PHASE 2 AND THE AND THE SURROUNDING AREA, INCLUDING PORTIONS OF HIGHLAND PARK, AND PROVIDE SAFER ACCESS FOR PEDESTRIANS AND BICYCLISTS This request is for the rehabilitation of the old pump house, or construction of a new building at the Ridgewood Reservoir site, to serve as an Environmental Center, with bathrooms. This reservoir is the closest place to a nature preserve anywhere near the Board 5 Queens area. Invasive Plant Species need to be removed. We are also requesting that funding be allocated to reconstruct ball fields in Highland Park, as Board 5 Queens has opposed development of reservoir basins for ball fields or other active recreational uses.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. There is no capital funding allocated to implement Phase 2.*

PROVIDE NEW STREET TREE PLANTINGS AND PROVIDE FUNDING FOR STUMP REMOVALS, PLANTING OF REPLACEMENT TREES, AND STREET TREE REMOVALS The tornado that devastated portions of the CB5Q area on 9/16/2010 resulted in the loss of several hundred trees completely, and has necessitated removal of dead trees, along with street tree stumps. Funding is needed to replace uprooted trees, for the removal and replacement of dead trees, for the removal of street tree stumps and for emergency pruning of dangerous street tree conditions. Hurricane Irene uprooted numerous additional trees. Consideration for new plantings should include: Grand Avenue, Metropolitan Avenue, Myrtle Avenue, Fresh Pond Road and Wyckoff Avenue. CB5Q has, for decades, pushed for new street tree plantings, with much success. Street trees reduce air pollution and beautify city streets. Asthma and other respiratory problems are a great concern.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. As part of our new Neighborhood Tree Planting approach, we will be planting trees in every viable location across the city on a predictable 9-year cycle, prioritizing the most heat-vulnerable neighborhoods first. Find out when we will be planting each neighborhood on the Parks website:*

*<https://www.nycgovparks.org/trees/street-tree-planting>. As part of our Neighborhood Tree Planting approach, dead trees and stumps will be removed and replaced with new trees where feasible. Parks' block pruning program provides neighborhood-based, proactive tree maintenance by addressing a portion of the street trees in each CB every year. Parks inspects, then prunes all city-owned street trees above 4" in diameter on a routine 7-year cycle, which is an industry standard. The goals of block pruning are to reduce damage caused during storms, avoid blocking traffic signals, remove dead branches, improve tree health and structure, and encourage growth away from built infrastructure. If there are individual trees in need of pruning for public safety in between this cycle, we encourage anyone to submit a service request by locating the tree on the NYC Tree Map (and clicking on the "report a problem" tab), calling 311, or using our online tree service request system. Our inspectors will visit the tree and determine the appropriate action in accordance with our Tree Risk Management Program. Forestry contract funding has been restored to pre-COVID levels. We agree that additional resources would increase capacity and help reduce our existing backlog of tree work, but that funding cannot be determined at this time.*

### 3 of 8 Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park (Mini Comfort Stations)

Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park

INSTALL MINI COMFORT STATIONS AT STARR PLAYGROUND, BENNINGER PLAYGROUND, UNCLE VITO MARANZANO'S GLENDALE PLAYGROUND, AND JUNIPER VALLEY PARK Starr Playground is located on Onderdonk Avenue at Starr Street, Benninger Park is located on Madison Street, just west of Fresh Pond Road, and Uncle Vito Maranzano's Glendale Playground is located on Central Avenue at 70th Street, The Juniper Valley Park comfort station request is for the section located between 80th Street and Dry Harbor Road and Juniper Blvd. North and South. This request is for the installation of mini comfort stations at each of these Parks Department properties. Too often people relieve themselves in corner areas of these smaller parks or adjacent to trees, posing very unhealthy conditions. Toilet facilities are needed, but the cost of these facilities in a park is astronomical.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. Because these parks are small, there is currently no space to install a restroom unless another amenity is removed. In addition, there is no funding allocated for projects at these sites.*



**4 of 8 Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Juniper Valley Park)****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

RECONSTRUCT THE LOWER BALLFIELDS IN JUNIPER VALLEY PARK (Fields 2 and 4) These soft surface baseball fields are deteriorated and need reconstruction, with consideration that these fields have also been used for youth soccer in recent years. These ballfields flood even during moderate rains, and can't be safely used for days after a moderate rain. Fields 1 and 3 were upgraded thanks to funding from the New York Mets.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Parks does not have capital funding allocated for this project. The board can reach out to its elected officials for capital funding requests.*

**5 of 8 Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Dry Harbor Playground)****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

RECONSTRUCT DRY HARBOR PLAYGROUND - PHASE 2, TO ALSO INCLUDE NEARBY TUNNEL AND PATHWAYS INTO FOREST PARK This City park is located on Myrtle Ave at 80 St, and is the only park for eastern Glendale. This Phase 2 request is for: replacement of the sewer line beneath the playground to alleviate flooding, rehabilitation of the asphalt softball field, and the park house/ bathrooms rehabilitation; and improved fencing around the children's playground. The reconstruction of the children's playground is completed. Funding is also needed to rehabilitate the tunnel and bicycle path under the Jackie Robinson Pkwy, and the connecting bicycle/golf cart pathway to its easterly connecting point of Forest Park Dr. Drainage, signage and lighting improvements are important along these pathways.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Parks understands the request and appreciates the boards support for this project. At this time, Parks only has partial funding and is not able to begin work until the project is fully funded. The board can reach out to its elected officials a capital funding request.*

**6 of 8 Establish a Community/Recreation Center in Maspeth****DPR**

Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park

ESTABLISH A COMMUNITY/RECREATION CENTER AT A SITE IN MASPETH The communities comprising District 5, Queens do not have a large indoor public space, other than schools, for recreation and community activities. This request is to build a new facility in Maspeth, preferably on a vacant parcel of land.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Parks does not have capital funding allocated for this request. The Board can reach out to local elected officials for a capital funding request.*

**7 of 8 Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park (Newtown Creek Aeration Property)****DPR**

Provide a new, or new expansion to, a building in a park

PROVIDE SAFE PUBLIC ACCESS TO NEWTOWN CREEK AND CONSTRUCT AN ATHLETIC FIELD AT THE NYC DEP NEWTOWN CREEK AERATION FACILITY PROPERTY The NYC DEP has had an aeration facility built at 58-26 47 Street, in Maspeth, Queens, to improve Newtown Creek water quality. Local soccer advocates request that the land owned by N.Y. City, adjacent to the planned aeration facility, be developed as an athletic field because there is a shortage of sites where soccer can be safely played.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

**8 of 8 Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (Evergreen Park)****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

Location: Saint Felix Avenue  
RECONSTRUCT EVERGREEN PARK PLAYGROUND IN GLENDALE - PHASE 3 This park is located on St. Felix Ave., between 60th Pl and 60th St, in Glendale, and is adjacent to PS 68. Thanks to funding allocated by Council Member Holden and Speaker Johnson, an innovative capital project will include basketball courts, a skate park area, volleyball courts, a walking track, and plantings. We look forward to the start of construction.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. This playground has capital funding to be reconstructed. Parks is still awaiting DEP SWPPP permit approval.*

**1 of 1 Establish a Contextual Senior Housing Residence in District 5, Queens****HPD**

Provide more housing for seniors

ESTABLISH A CONTEXTUAL SENIOR HOUSING RESIDENCE IN DISTRICT 5, QUEENS There is a significant need for affordable housing for seniors in Community District 5, Queens. Many older adults have little or no income other than Social Security, and apartment rents are not affordable for many seniors. Senior housing is needed that is in accord with neighborhood building character.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. HPD will continue to fund the construction of senior housing from the development pipeline to maximize available resources.*

**1 of 2 Other transit infrastructure requests (L Line Stations)****NYCTA**

Other transit infrastructure requests

RECONSTRUCT THE DEKALB AVENUE, HALSEY STREET, AND JEFFERSON STREET TRAIN STATIONS (BMT- L Line) Only the Halsey Street Train Station is in Queens, but many of our Ridgewood residents either use these stations, or would use them, if they were not so deteriorated and if they were more inviting. ADA accessibility is needed at these stations, especially at DeKalb Avenue. There is increased development along the Brooklyn/Queens border, and we need to ensure that these train stations are modernized and rehabilitated. We are informed that, in 2012, the Halsey St. station had the largest percentage growth in passengers of any "L" train stations.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

**2 of 2 Other transit infrastructure requests (LIRR)****NYCTA**

Other transit infrastructure requests

REPLACE OR REPOWER POLLUTING STAGE ZERO FREIGHT ENGINES The use of freight rail locally has increased significantly in recent years, but the communities of Glendale, Middle Village, Ridgewood and Maspeth have suffered as a result. This request is for the replacement or repowering of old locomotives leased by N.Y. and Atlantic Railway from MTA/LIRR, with Tier 4 Switch Duty Cycle Locomotives. These old locomotives pollute our communities. 2 of the 11 old freight locomotives have been replaced thanks to State Funding obtained by Assembly Member Hevesi and other local State elected officials. One old locomotive was replaced thanks to a Federal EPA match. State funding has been allocated for more than 5 additional new freight locomotives, but MTA/LIRR have still not put out a bid.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

**1 of 1 Renovate or upgrade existing precinct house****NYPD**

Renovate or upgrade existing precinct houses

REHABILITATE THE 104TH POLICE PRECINCT INTERIOR AND EXTERIOR The 104th Police Precinct station house is an old building and ongoing improvements needed include: heating system upgrades, plumbing upgrades (including: waste lines, supervisor's bathroom on the 1st floor, 2nd floor male bathroom and prisoner bathroom), electrical upgrades, windows replacement, providing handicapped access, fixing basement leaks, central air conditioning, and refurbishing the main desk. Problems with leaks from the waste lines are causing human waste to leak into precinct area on the lower floors and in the basement.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Capital projects for boiler replacement and heating upgrades is currently in design. Capital project for ADA accessibility upgrades is in pre-design.*



**1 of 1 Provide a new or expand an existing high school****SCA**

Provide a new or expand an existing high school

CONSTRUCT NEW HIGH SCHOOLS IN QUEENS, INCLUDING A NEW VOCATIONAL HIGH SCHOOL, AND PERFORM CAPITAL UPGRADES TO SCHOOL BUILDINGS This request includes Construction of New High Schools in Queens, including a new vocational high school, considering that many youth are very well suited to a career in electrical, plumbing and other trades and there is significant demand for skilled workers in many trades. For years there has been a shortage of high schools locally for Queens's teenagers. There is also an ongoing need to renovate existing school buildings.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. The agency agrees with this request, will accommodate in part.*

**CS Reconstruct Mafera Park****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

RECONSTRUCT MAFERA PARK Mafera Park is located on 65 Place at 68 Avenue. This vital park is on the Ridgewood/Glendale border and has the only major soft surface sports area for these communities. Much of this park is in need of reconstruction, including the children's playground (which is funded), and the asphalt softball field, much of which hasn't been reconstructed since 1995.

*Agency Response: This request has already been completed. The asphalt field was recently reconstructed, there's new synthetic turf, and the playground is funded to be reconstructed.*

**CS Reconstruct Benninger Playground****DPR**

Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

RECONSTRUCT BENNINGER PLAYGROUND & PROVIDE A MINI COMFORT STATION Benninger Playground, located on Madison Street, just west of Fresh Pond Road, is used extensively. The playground is in need of Reconstruction, including the Children's Playground and Basketball and Handball Court Areas. Fortunately, we are informed that Council Member Holden has allocated capital projects funding for this important reconstruction project and construction has begun. A mini comfort station is needed at this active park, due to some patrons using the park as their toilet.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Parks does not have capital funding allocated to install a restroom at the park. The board can reach out to Parks to figure out if there is enough space in the playground for a restroom without removing other amenities in the park.*

**EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS****1 of 1 Fund an ACS Satellite Office in Queens****ACS**

Other foster care and child welfare requests

FUND AN ADMINISTRATION FOR CHILDRENS SERVICES SATELLITE OFFICE IN QUEENS There is a need for a Administration for Childrens Services satellite office, especially during the 6 p.m. to 8 a.m. hours, to operate weekdays and weekends. Many children in the CB#5 Queens area have sought sanctuary from abusive parents, relatives and other individuals. With ACS staff hours limited, the abuse of children is too often unattended and the problem situation continues.

*Agency Response: This request has already been completed. ACS already has 3 borough offices in Queens: 165-15 Archer Avenue, 1st Fl. 718-480-4392 90-25 161st Street, 3rd Fl. 718-262-1324 92-31 Union Hall Street, 3rd Fl. 718-725-3784*

**1 of 2 Provide field workers for Bureau of Water and Sewer Operations****DEP**

Inspect sanitary sewer on specific street segment and repair or replace as needed

PROVIDE FIELD WORKERS FOR THE BUREAU OF WATER AND SEWER OPERATIONS Field workers in sufficient numbers are needed to ensure that City water remains excellent; that catch basins are cleaned and repaired and sewer lines are flushed in a reasonable amount of time; that sewer backups and leaks are corrected expeditiously and that sewer repairs and fire hydrant repairs are performed in a timely manner. Cave-in conditions in the road and adjacent to catch basins too often have gone unrepaired for months, presenting dangerous conditions.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

**2 of 2 Hire operations staff for the Bureau of Wastewater Pollution Control****DEP**

Investigate odor complaints about a wastewater facility and address/repair or make equipment improvements as needed

HIRE OPERATIONS STAFF FOR THE BUREAU OF WASTEWATER POLLUTION CONTROL Sufficient Staffing is needed to perform odor and water pollution control monitoring at wastewater treatment facilities in New York City. Odors from wastewater treatment facilities pose health hazards, will likely cause residents to move and could severely hamper business investment. Locally, we are most concerned about the Newtown Creek Water Pollution Control Plant.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.*

**1 of 1 Provide needed services for Seniors****DFTA**

Increase staffing for homebound adult programs

PROVIDE NEEDED SERVICES FOR SENIOR CITIZENS Community District 5, Queens has a very large senior citizen population, many of whom are frail, without adequate care and living alone. The following are necessary programs to meet some of the needs of senior citizens: 1) Provide adequate funding for Meals-on-Wheels programs; 2) Provide adequate funding for congregate meals programs; 3) Provide funding for senior transportation programs; 4) Fund Health Care Programs for the Elderly and Senior Home Care; 5) Fund Emergency Food Programs for Seniors.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Need additional funding to meet this request.*

**1 of 1 Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)****DOB**

Assign additional building inspectors (including expanding training programs)

HIRE INSPECTORS AND PLAN EXAMINERS, IN SUFFICIENT NUMBERS, TO COPE WITH ILLEGAL USES OF PROPERTY AND QUESTIONABLE CONSTRUCTION A separate afternoon/evening and weekend inspection team of 10 inspectors for Queens is critical because inspectors very often can't gain access in the daytime during the work-week. Communities throughout Queens have been plagued with illegal apartments posing dangerous conditions, school overcrowding and more pressure on limited City services. Construction inspectors and plan examiners in adequate numbers are needed to curtail contractors building homes larger than the zoning permits. Currently to our knowledge, Queens has 26 plan examiners and only 15 construction inspectors usually working in the borough.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. Agency will continue with existing resources and funding. The agency recruits and train staff to enforce the building code.*

**1 of 1 Hire additional personnel for pest control****DOHMH**

Animal and pest control requests including reducing rat and mosquito populations

HIRE ADDITIONAL PERSONNEL FOR PEST CONTROL TO REDUCE THE ENORMOUS RAT POPULATION IN OUR CITY The Borough of Queens has too few staff to adequately address the rodent infestation problem, which has increased with the growth of dump-out locations and vacant properties. A minimum of 4 additional inspectors and 4 additional staff to bait are needed for Queens.

*Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Public Health Sanitarians and Exterminators are niche public service positions that require minimum education and certifications. Challenges remain for recruitment and hiring as these civil service title requirements are governed by state laws and remains a challenge*

**1 of 3 Fund additional street maintenance for roadways and curbs****DOT**

Other traffic improvement requests

FUND ADDITIONAL STREET MAINTENANCE FOR QUEENS ROADWAYS AND CURBS In order to have roadways along commercial strips and in residential communities repaired before dangerous conditions arise, the following requests need to be funded: provide one crew for cave-in repair; 2 crews for pothole repairs; 1 crew for concrete repair; 2 crews for curb replacement; and 1 crew for miscellaneous maintenance (ponding conditions, etc.) daily for Queens. Lawsuits against the City might be greatly reduced if repairs could be done more promptly.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DOT will continue to provide service with existing personnel and resources.*

**2 of 3 Provide sufficient personnel funding to ensure traffic safety****DOT**

Other traffic improvement requests

PROVIDE SUFFICIENT PERSONNEL FOR TRAFFIC SAFETY INSPECTIONS, SIGN INSTALLATIONS, PAVEMENT MARKINGS AND SIGN MANUFACTURING Because of increasingly dangerous local traffic conditions, there has been a need during the past 10 years for more traffic safety studies, traffic signals, All Way Stop installations, Speed Bump installations, One Way Conversions, and No Parking designations to daylight intersections. Additional traffic device maintenance crews are needed for signage installation, pavement markings and sign manufacturing. Vehicles in good repair, including utility trucks, are needed to support current and projected staffing levels.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DOT will continue to provide service with existing personnel and resources.*

**3 of 3 Improve arterial highways cleaning and maintenance****DOT**

Other traffic improvement requests

IMPROVE ARTERIAL HIGHWAYS CLEANING AND MAINTENANCE The conditions of arterial highways and their cleanliness should be a priority for the City and State of New York. Maintenance workers citywide are needed to repair and resurface roadbeds, repair and replace dividers, clean litter & debris, attend to growth, and eliminate graffiti in a timely manner.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DOT will continue to provide service with existing resources and personnel.*

**1 of 3 Hire Forestry personnel****DPR**

Forestry services, including street tree maintenance

HIRE FORESTRY PERSONNEL With previous cuts, the Forestry Division had been decimated. At one point, there were only 4 climbers and pruners to care for more than 327,000 street trees in Queens. Queens needs at least 55 climbers and pruners to remove and prune trees posing dangerous conditions.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We agree with the need to increase staff and capacity to address our existing backlog of tree work, but that funding cannot be determined at this time. NYC Parks has made strides to increase its in-house tree work capacity through the Climber & Pruner Training Program, an in-house training program that connects current entry-level Parks employees with the training to become Climber & Pruners. With this program, Parks expects to add 15-20 new Climber & Pruners to the workforce every 15 months to help mitigate recruitment and hiring challenges.*

**2 of 3 Need for more park maintenance personnel and equipment****DPR**

Provide better park maintenance

ASSIGN MORE PERSONNEL AND EQUIPMENT FOR MAINTENANCE OF PARKS IN DISTRICT 5, QUEENS More park workers are needed to meet work requirements for the cleaning and maintenance of the 229.7 acres of parks in CD5Q. Currently, there are only 10 Parks Dept. maintenance staff, including supervisors, assigned for this massive parkland. Skilled maintenance workers (there are only 2 for all of Queens Districts 5, 9, 10 & Forest Park) should be funded year-round. Reseeding, aerating and fertilizing ball fields and grassy areas need to be priorities so that large capital expenditures are not wasted. Funding is also needed to hire more seasonal workers. Long standing vehicle needs include a new Crew Cab and a new Packer.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Funding cannot be determined at this time*

**3 of 3 Increased Funding for Division of Forestry in Queens****DPR**

Forestry services, including street tree maintenance

ALLOCATE FUNDING FOR THE OPERATION AND ENHANCEMENT OF THE DIVISION OF FORESTRY IN QUEENS There are extensive needs for pruning of trees on city streets and in city parks, which are too numerous for the Division of Forestry to keep up with. There are currently thousands of street tree stumps that need to be removed in Queens. The following budget allocations are needed to address these conditions, and the need to remove dead trees and limbs on an emergency basis: \$4.5 Million for county-wide pruning contract; \$3.5 Million for removal of tree stumps in Queens; \$2 million for removal of dead trees and limbs. Trees are aging, and risks of falling limbs and dead trees pose dangerous conditions.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We agree that additional funding would increase the capacity of our Forestry Division, but additional funding cannot be determined at this time.*

**1 of 3 Provide more staffing to address illegal dumping and litter basket collection****DSNY**

Provide more frequent litter basket collection

PROVIDE MORE SANITATION DEPARTMENT CLEANING PERSONNEL, TO CLEAN ILLEGAL DUMPING AND FOR LITTER BASKET COLLECTIONS Illegal dumping and garbage drop-off locations are a consistent problem in District 5, Queens. In order to alleviate these very problematic conditions, which are potential health hazards and hamper business investment: 1. Restore Clean Team personnel to clean dump-out and drop-off locations on a regular basis, 2. Provide adequate personnel to empty litter baskets 7 days a week.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time.*

**2 of 3 Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions****DSNY**

Provide more frequent garbage or recycling pick-up for schools and institutions

CONTINUE 5 TIMES PER WEEK GARBAGE COLLECTION AND BEGIN 5 DAY A WEEK RECYCLING COLLECTION AT SCHOOLS The reduction to 2 days per week garbage collection caused unsanitary conditions around many local schools. School collection, 5 days per week, is critical during the school year and during the Summer. It is also important that recycling collection at schools be increased. Five times a week recycling collection is needed for many public schools, as the current conditions result in recyclables crowding school sidewalks.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. Compost is collected five times a week from City Schools, Paper is collected three times a week, and Metal/Glass/Plastic is collected twice a week. Trash is collected on the neighborhood schedule, but with proper sorting of materials School collection should be properly routed at present.*

**3 of 3 Increase Sanitation Police and Enforcement Agents****DSNY**

Other enforcement requests

INCREASE THE NUMBER OF SANITATION POLICE AND ENFORCEMENT AGENTS, ESPECIALLY IN PLAIN CLOTHES, TO SIGNIFICANTLY REDUCE EXCESSIVE ABUSE OF LITTER BASKETS AND ILLEGAL DUMPING Because of previous lay-offs, there are now fewer Sanitation Police citywide for illegal dumping. Sanitation Police positions should be greatly increased for illegal dumping, especially since they are revenue producing, and dumping is severely hurting communities. One SEA agent is needed daily in Q5. Severe fines, vehicle impoundments and more publicity, such as frequent press releases to TV and radio stations and major newspapers, are needed to make an example of dumpers and curtail illegal dumping. The abuse of litter baskets on commercial strips has become deplorable, and needs to be better addressed.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time.*

**1 of 1 Provide, expand, or enhance after school programs for middle school students (grades 6-8)****DYCD**

Provide, expand, or enhance after school programs for middle school students (grades 6-8)

PROVIDE FUNDING FOR EDUCATIONAL AND RECREATIONAL PROGRAMS FOR CHILDREN AND TEENS After school, evening and weekend delinquency prevention programs should be maintained locally. This is especially critical at a time when far too many children and teenagers are unsupervised by parents or guardians after the school day ends and on weekends. These programs are very critical as they increase self-esteem levels of participants, thereby preventing substance abuse and delinquent behavior. While Beacon Programs are welcome, it is vital that funding for other quality "local" education and recreation programs be a priority. Thankfully, recent Mayors and City Council Members have increased youth program funding substantially.

*Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DYCD has begun a three-year, 20,000 seat expansion of the COMPASS afterschool program.*

**1 of 2 Provide funding for appropriate FDNY staffing****FDNY**

Provide more firefighters or EMS workers

PROVIDE FUNDING FOR FIRE DEPARTMENT SERVICES Funding is needed for the following essential Fire Department Services: maintain engine companies and ladder companies at current staffing levels; provide funding for the Department's Building Unit; ensure adequate staffing for excellent maintenance of FDNY apparatus and other vehicles; and provide sufficient funding for the Fire Safety Education Unit. Priority should also be given to hiring a sufficient number of EMS staff to cope with increased needs for the life-saving services that they provide in our city.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. FDNY is planning to maximize Firefighter and EMT hiring in FY27.*

**2 of 2 Provide funds for tools and equipment for local department personnel****FDNY**

Other expense budget request for FDNY

PROVIDE FUNDS FOR TOOLS AND EQUIPMENT FOR LOCAL FIRE DEPARTMENT PERSONNEL AND FOR FIRE PREVENTION PROGRAM SUPPLIES Hurst Tools, Rabbit Tools, defibrillators, power saws, first aid equipment, etc., are needed to ensure the safety of local residents. Funding for Fire Fighters' face pieces is also an important need. Funding is also requested to purchase 10,000 smoke detectors, at a total cost of approximately \$100,000, and 10,000 carbon monoxide detectors, at a cost of \$200,000 for distribution to the public throughout the year. Funding is requested to purchase 10,000 new CPR kits for public training and distribution.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FDNY will seek to accommodate within existing resources, although this will depend on availability of funding and overall agency prioritization. The Community Board should continue work with their relevant elected officials to allocate Council/BP funding at Budget Adoption.*

**1 of 1 Other expense budget request for HHC (Ridgewood Medical Center)****HHC**

Other expense budget request for HHC

CONTINUE FUNDING OF THE RIDGEWOOD MEDICAL CENTER, NOW RENAMED GOTHAM HEALTH/CUMBERLAND The Ridgewood Medical Center (formerly known as the Maspeth Child Health Station and Ridgewood Communicare Health Center) provides important health services to many children, families and senior citizens. Ridgewood and neighboring communities have seen an increase in the number of people struggling economically. The need to expand services beyond the hours of Mon. to Fri., 8:30am to 4:30pm, should be seriously considered to serve workers and workers with children.

*Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. The System believes that the hours of operations and staffing at this facility are adequate*

**1 of 2 Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations****HPD**

Provide, expand, or enhance programs for housing inspections to correct code violations

ALLOCATE FUNDING FOR DEPT. OF HOUSING PRESERVATION AND DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMS Adequate funding must be appropriated to cope with illegal residential property uses ,deteriorating housing stock, and harassment of tenants by greedy landlords. The needs include HPD Code Enforcement Inspectors; funding for housing rehabilitation loan programs; substantial funding for tenant legal services, and for demolition and seal up operations in Queens. Currently, to our knowledge, only 21 Inspectors are assigned to Queens of 336 Inspectors working in N.Y. City.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. This is a priority for the administration and HPD and we will continue to work with key stakeholders to ensure poor housing conditions in NYC are properly enforced.*



**2 of 2 Increase funding for Community Consultant contracts****HPD**

Other housing oversight and emergency housing programs

**INCREASE FUNDING FOR COMMUNITY CONSULTANT CONTRACTS** In Q5 there are many multiple dwellings owned by landlords who need technical assistance related to leases, paperwork and tenant matters. Tenants are often in need of advice and assistance related to lease matters and landlords who do not upkeep property. In Q5, the Greater Ridgewood Restoration Corp. has a history of helping landlords and tenants. This organization has also prevented hundreds of properties from being taken from owners in lien sales, through excellent outreach to owners.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. HPD employs a variety of strategies to conduct outreach and distribute critical information to tenants and property owners across the city. These efforts include tabling events, the HPD Van, and participation in resource fairs, often in collaboration with local community-based organizations, community boards, and elected officials. For homeowners, HPD is relaunching two key initiatives—the Homeowner Help Desk and HomeFix—both administered by the Center for New York City Neighborhoods. The Homeowner Help Desk provides funding to community-based organizations to support homeowners, while HomeFix offers access to affordable financing and technical assistance for necessary home repairs. For tenants, HPD has expanded its Partners in Preservation program, which offers substantial funding to community-based organizations to strengthen their organizing teams and extend services and resources to more tenants in need. Funding for Community Consultant Contracts and Stabilizing NYC is allocated by the City Council. HPD does not control these allocations.*

**1 of 1 Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing****HRA**

Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing

**PROVIDE FUNDING FOR RENTAL ASSISTANCE PROGRAMS TO REDUCE HOMELESSNESS** Consistent, adequate funding is needed for programs such as the Living in Communities Rental Assistance Program (LINC), to prevent people from becoming homeless, and to move people from shelters to more permanent housing.

*Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Homelessness prevention is one of the Agency's priorities. Funds have been allocated in the budget for these services.*

**1 of 2 Hire additional uniformed officers****NYPD**

Hire additional uniformed officers

**ASSIGN ADDITIONAL PERSONNEL FOR THE 104TH POLICE PRECINCT PATROL FORCE** Within the last 12 years, the patrol strength of the 104th Pct. has dropped under 130 officers. At least 170 officers are needed for the 104th Pct., plus supervisors, to cope with robbery, burglary, felony assaults, some violent crime, domestic violence, scams, some inadequate response times, vehicular speeding, much illegal parking, auto theft and rowdy conditions often caused by substance abuse.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. NYPD total staffing levels depend on decisions made in the Preliminary and Executive budget process. Allocation of uniformed personnel is scheduled by the NYPD only after graduation of Police classes from the Academy. Availability of civilian personnel is limited due to reductions to the civilian headcount.*

**2 of 2 Hire additional School Safety Officers, Crossing Guards, and Traffic Agents****NYPD**

Other NYPD staff resources requests

HIRE ADDITIONAL SCHOOL SAFETY OFFICERS, CROSSING GUARDS AND TRAFFIC CONTROL AGENTS In consideration of dangerous traffic conditions, funding is needed to hire at least 5 additional school crossing guards for District 5, Queens schools. Most elementary schools have only 1 or 2 School Safety Officers; intermediate schools only have 3 officers, which in many schools is very insufficient. The city should earmark funding to hire additional traffic control agents (Traffic Enforcement Agents-Level 2) so that heavily travelled intersections can be staffed. This will diminish the need to assign Police Officers, who are paid more and need to be reducing crime.

*Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Based on the latest budget, the NYPD has a specific budgeted headcount. The agency is working on filling vacancies in order to get to that headcount.*

**1 of 1 Provide seven day service at local libraries****QL**

Extend library hours or expand and enhance library programs

PROVIDE AT LEAST SEVEN-DAY-A-WEEK SERVICE AT LOCAL LIBRARIES Increased educational demands on students, the fact that many families cannot afford the internet or up-to-date computers and increasing immigrant populations necessitate that the great majority of local/branch libraries be open at least 6-days a week. Having Libraries open on Saturdays is especially important to many residents! Some of the more utilized public branch libraries should be open 7 days a week.

*Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. QPL offers universal six-day library service, including Saturdays, at its branches. The agency agrees with seven-day library service, but funding cannot be determined at this time.*